Satavahanas — BEFORE the pilot

APPSC Complete 3.45 · AP History rows 46–49: the old notes and the old PYQ keys

- Old notes — row 46: Satavahanas – Origin, Simuka, Gautamiputra Satakarni, Nasik Prasasti, Vasishthiputra Pulumavi
- Position in the Dynastic Sequence
- Puranic Accounts
- Literary Works
- Foreign Accounts
- Later Satavahana–Kardamaka Relations
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- Old notes — row 47: Satavahana Administration, Economy, Coinage and Prakrit Literature (hala's Gathasaptasati)
- Units
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- Women
- Social Picture in the Gathasaptasati
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- FIRST / LAST / SPECIAL FACTS
- Old notes — row 48: Satavahana Art and Architecture – Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda and Rock-cut Caves
- Structure Types
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- Buddha's Life → Symbol
- Phases and Patrons
- Discovery and Dispersal
- Excavation and Submergence
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- FIRST / LAST / SPECIAL FACTS
- Old notes — row 49: Satavahana Religious Conditions – Buddhism, Brahmanism and Royal Patronage
- Naneghat Inscription
- Other Vedic Evidence
- Bhagavata Religion
- Gudimallam
- FIRST / LAST / SPECIAL FACTS
- Old PYQs and keys — row 46 (94)
- Old PYQs and keys — row 47 (96)
- Old PYQs and keys — row 48 (41)
- Old PYQs and keys — row 49 (18)

Old notes — row 46: Satavahanas – Origin, Simuka, Gautamiputra Satakarni, Nasik Prasasti, Vasishthiputra Pulumavi

The Dynasty – Names, Firsts and Sequence

- **First historical ruling dynasty of the Deccan**; oldest Deccan dynasty (c. 200 BC – 200 AD); a **bridge between north and south India**; queens had a public voice.
- **First (major) dynasty to rule Andhra**; **first kings to issue inscriptions in Andhra itself** (Ashoka's were earlier in time).
- Began as **feudatories of the Mauryas**; became free in the Deccan after Mauryan decline. Andhras won freedom from the Mauryas under the Satavahanas; first king **Srimukha (Simuka)**.
- **Puranic names**: **Andhras / Andhrabhrityas** (= "servants of the Andhras", or Andhras who had been feudatories).
- Seen as **Brahmins**: the Nasik inscription calls Gautamiputra **"Ekabrahmana"**.
- **First to make tax-free land grants** to Buddhists and Brahmanas.

Position in the Dynastic Sequence

Stage	Dynasties
Magadha	**Mauryas → Sungas → Kanvas → Satavahanas** (Simuka ended the Kanvas; a Satavahana king defeated **Kanva Susarma**)
Successors	**Ikshvakus** (Andhra), **Abhiras** (Maharashtra), **Vakatakas** (Vidarbha), Chutus, Pallavas
Later in the Deccan	**Chalukyas**, then **Rashtrakutas**

- **Ikshvaku Virapurushadatta**: his reign = **golden age of Buddhism** at Nagarjunakonda; Upasika **Bodhisri** contributed to Buddhism.
- **Earliest copper-plate grant (Andhra):** the **Patagandigudem** copper plates of Ikshvaku king **Ehuvala Chamtamula** (3rd c. CE) are the earliest known copper-plate land grant of south India; they record a grant to a **Buddhist monastery**.

Origin Debate – Scholars and Theories

View	Scholar
"**Andhras and Satavahanas are not the same**"; home in the Kannada (**Bellary**) region, from the **Myakadoni** inscription	**V.S. Sukthankar**
Andhras and Satavahanas were the same people	**R.G. Bhandarkar**
Satavahanas were **Andhrabhrityas**	V.S. Sukthankar (G2 2008), V.V. Mirashi, R.G. Bhandarkar
Home in **Vidarbha (Berar)**	**V.V. Mirashi**
Origin in the **eastern Deccan (Andhra)**, from Puranic "Andhra" names	**E.J. Rapson**, R.G. Bhandarkar
Rejected Bellary (no early inscription there); favoured **Maharashtra**	**Gopalachari**
Andhras, not Andhrabhrityas	**D.C. Sircar**
Andhra = **tribal** name; Satavahana = **dynastic**; Satakarni = **family** name	**K.A. Nilakanta Sastri**
Belonged to the original **Andhra janapada**	**B.S.L. Hanumantha Rao**
Dravidians	**R.S. Sharma**

- Homeland stays unresolved: Maharashtra vs Andhra vs Bellary vs Vidarbha; **Kotilingala** (Telangana) also claimed.

For APPSC follow the keys: "not the same" = **Sukthankar** (2012); Bellary theory from Myakadoni = Sukthankar (2017 key), not **Bhandarkar**.

Sources – Puranas, Literature, Foreign Accounts

Puranic Accounts

Purana	Kings	Years	Note
Matsya	**30**	**456** (271 BCE–174 CE)	**Longest**, most systematic list; compiled in **Yajnasri**'s reign; basis of political history
Vayu / Vishnu	**17**	**272**	Not treated as standard

- Rulers **1-23 = early Satavahanas**; **24-30 = later Satavahanas**.
- **Long chronology**: 271 BC – 174 AD (Simuka c. 230-207 BCE). **Short chronology**: c. 1st c. BCE – 3rd c. CE.
- **Last king per the Puranas: Pulomavi III** (30th); known from the **Myakadoni** inscription. ⚠ APPSC key (2011) gave **Chandasri (Chanda Sati)**, citing the Matsya Purana.

Literary Works

Work	Author / language / note
Kathasaritsagara	**Somadeva (Kashmir)**, Sanskrit, from Brihatkatha
Brihatkatha	**Gunadhya**, **Paisachi**
Katantra	**Sharvavarman** (Kundala Satakarni's time)
Leelavati Parinayam	**Kutuhala**
Gathasaptasati	**Hala**; Prakrit, **700 verses** on rural life and love

- Works on **early Satavahana history**: **Kathasaritsagara, Pratishthanapura-kalpa, Dvatrimsatputtalika**; also Jain and **Dipavamsa** traditions.
- **Chulakalinga Jataka** and **Hathigumpha** record Kalinga contact: **Kharavela** sent an army west ignoring his contemporary **Satakarni I**.
- **Kanhabenna:** Hathigumpha's name for the **Krishna** river, to which Kharavela sent his army.

Gathasaptasati does NOT narrate early Satavahana history (G2 2017).

Foreign Accounts

Writer	Note
Megasthenes	Andhras lived in towns
Pliny	*Natural History*; mentions the Andhra kingdom
Ptolemy	*Geography*; records **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi vs Chashtana** clashes
Periplus	Saka–Satavahana conflict

Rulers – Period – Contribution

No.	Ruler	Period	Contribution
1st	**Simuka (Srimukha)**	c. 230-207 BCE	**Founder** (per Puranas); founder of administration; overthrew the Kanvas; power in north Maharashtra, upper Godavari
2nd	**Kanha (Krishna)**	—	**First Satavahana inscription** (Nasik); **Dharma Mahamatra**
3rd	**Satakarni I**	c. 180 BCE	Greatest early ruler; **Ashvamedha**; **first silver coins**; expanded into Central India; Kharavela's contemporary
6th	**Satakarni II**	—	**Longest reign – 56 years**; **Sanchi torana**
17th	**Hala**	5 years	**Gathasaptasati**; **Kavivatsala**
23rd	**Gautamiputra Satakarni**	c. 106-130 CE	**Greatest of all**; last of the early Satavahanas
24th	**Vasishthiputra Pulumavi**	c. 130-159 CE	Nasik Prasasti issued; Amaravati inscription; capital to Amaravati; **ship coins**
—	**Vasishthiputra (Sivasri) Satakarni**	Later	Married **Rudradaman's daughter**
27th	**Yajna Sri Satakarni**	c. 170-199 CE	**Greatest of the later rulers**; won back territory; **ship coins** (maritime revival); patron of **Nagarjuna**
—	**Chanda Satakarni**	Later	**Kodavali** inscription
30th	**Pulomavi III**	—	**Last** king; defeated by Ikshvaku **Srisantamula**; last days at **Myakadoni (Bellary)**

- **Sanchi south torana** names **Siri Satakarni** (Satakarni I/II), not Gautamiputra.
- **Amaravati stupa**: enlarged under the Satavahanas; **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi** is the standard patron; some keys name Vasishthiputra Satakarni or Srimukha (stone railing around the Mahachaitya); the 2001 key placed the railing in Yajnasri Satakarni's time (by Nagarjuna).

Gautamiputra = **23rd** king; "28th" is an error. Founder **Simuka**; longest **Satakarni II**; last **Pulomavi III**.

Gautamiputra Satakarni and the Kshaharata Conflict

Side	Rulers / records
Satavahana	**Gautamiputra Satakarni** ("destroyer of the Sakas")

Side	Rulers / records
Kshaharata (Western Kshatrapa)	**Nahapana**; son-in-law **Ushavadatta (Rishabhadatta)** – Nasik and Karle records; minister **Ayama** – **Junnar** record

- Defeated **Nahapana** and regained **Malwa, Saurashtra, Konkan, Nasik** (APPSC 2000).
- **Jogalthambi hoard** (Nasik district): Nahapana's **silver coins restruck** by Gautamiputra; confirms the Prasasti.
- Ushavadatta's Nasik record: **2,000 karshapanas** in a **weavers' guild** at **12%** interest.
- Gautamiputra re-granted land formerly held by Ushavadatta to monks.

Later Satavahana–Kardamaka Relations

- Kardamaka rivals: **Chashtana** and **Rudradaman**.
- **Junagadh inscription** (Sanskrit, c. 150 CE): Rudradaman **twice defeated Satakarni**, lord of Dakshinapatha, but **spared** him as a near relative.
- **Kanheri** inscription: queen of Vasishthiputra Satakarni = **daughter of Rudradaman**.
- After Rudradaman's attacks, **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi** shifted the centre east to **Dhanyakataka (Amaravati)** and extended rule into **coastal Andhra**.
- **Yajnasri Satakarni** recovered lost territory from the Western Kshatrapas.

Salivahana era (AD 78) credit to Gautamiputra does not fit his c. 106-130 CE dates.

Nasik Prasasti

Particular	Fact
Issuer	**Gautami Balasri**, mother of Gautamiputra
Reign	**19th regnal year** of her grandson **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi**
Language / script	**Prakrit prose, Brahmi**
Content	Gautamiputra's expeditions, victories, empire, titles
Praise	"Destroyer of **Sakas, Yavanas and Pahlavas**"

- Main source for Gautamiputra's reign; a family eulogy, so conquest claims may be exaggerated.
- Gifts with Balasri to monks on **Trirashmi hill**: a village and **100 nivartanas** of his own land; Balasri called wife of a **Rajarshi**.

Social and Religious Claims

- Classes the line as **Brahmana**; also “**crusher of Kshatriya pride**”.
- **Protector of the varna system**: **Varnasankarya-nirodhaka** – stopped intercaste marriage among the four varnas; patron of Brahmanism.

Regions Named

Region	Modern area
Asika, Asaka (Asmaka), Mulaka	Godavari valley, Paithan area
Suratha, Kukura	Saurashtra; western Malwa-Rajasthan
Aparanta	**North Konkan**
Anupa	**Narmada valley**, capital **Mahishmati**
Vidarbha	**Berar**
Akara / **Avanti**	**East Malwa** (Vidisha) / **West Malwa** (Ujjain)

Inscriptions on Gautamiputra

Site	Relevance
Nasik	**Military victories** (G2 2008)
Naneghat	Satakarni I and Naganika – not Gautamiputra
Junnar, Karle	Kshaharata records – distractors

Royal Titles

Title	Ruler
Dakshinapathapati, Apratihatachakra (Naneghat)	**Satakarni I**
Kavivatsala (love of poetry)	**Hala**
Ekabrahmana, Ekashura, Shakasanhari, Trisamudra-toya-pita-vahana, Kshatriya-darpa-mana-mardana, Varnasankarya-nirodhaka, Dvijakula-vardhana, Agama-nilaya, Dakshina-samudradhishwara	**Gautamiputra Satakarni**
Dakshinapatheshwara, Navanagaraswami	**Vasishthiputra Pulumavi**
Trisamudradhipati / Trisamudradheeshwara (Banabhatta)	**Yajna Sri Satakarni**
Gautamiputra's title	Meaning
Trisamudra-toya-pita-vahana	Whose horses drank the waters of **three seas**
Kshatriya-darpa-mana-mardana	Crusher of the pride of the Kshatriyas
Varnasankarya-nirodhaka	Stopper of the mixing of varnas
Ekabrahmana	Unique Brahmana

"Horses drank the waters of three seas" = **Gautamiputra**; a key may also give him "Trisamudradhipati", which is usually Yajna Sri's.

Queens and Metronymics

Queen	Role
Devi Naganika	Wife of **Satakarni I**; daughter of **Maharathi Tranakayiro**; **regent** for her minor son(s); issued **Naneghat**; co-performed **Ashvamedha and Rajasuya**
Gautami Balasri	Mother of Gautamiputra; **Nasik Prasasti**; built a Nasik cave for **Bhadrayaniya** monks
Lilavati	Sri Lankan princess, queen of **Hala** (distractor)

- **Metronymics**: kings put their **mother's (gotra) name** before their own – Gautamiputra, Vasishthiputra, Halamiputra.
- **Begin with Gautamiputra Satakarni** (G2 2008); usual explanation: **polygamy** (princes told apart by their mothers).
- Significance: **high status of royal women**, respect for the mother; but **succession stayed patriarchal**.

Inscriptions – Issuer and Findspot

Inscription	Issuer / ruler	Content	Findspot
Naneghat	**Devi Naganika**	Satakarni I's victories; Vedic sacrifices; gifts to Brahmins	Naneghat pass (Pune)
Nasik (Kanha)	**Krishna**, 2nd king	First Satavahana inscription	Nasik
Nasik Prasasti	**Gautami Balasri**	Gautamiputra's victories	Nasik caves

Inscription	Issuer / ruler	Content	Findspot
Amaravati	**Pulumavi II**	Gateway pillar; **first Telugu word “Nagabu”**; Chaitika sangha	Amaravati, AP
Karle / Bhaja	Pulumavi II’s reign	Cave donations	Western Maharashtra
Karle	**Vasishthiputra Pulumavi**	Village for **Mahasanghika** bhikshus	Karle
Kanheri	Queen of Vasishthiputra Satakarni	Daughter of Rudradaman	Mumbai
Kodavali	**Chanda Satakarni**	Later record	**East Godavari** (Pithapuram)
Myakadoni	Last Pulumavi	Final phase	**Bellary**, Karnataka
Nagarjunakonda	Yajna Sri	Mahavihara records	Palnadu

- All in **Prakrit**, **Brahmi** script.
- **Earliest** inscriptions from **Maharashtra** (Naneghat, Kanha’s Nasik) (G2 2025); later coastal Andhra (Amaravati), Karnataka (Myakadoni), Kodavali-type records.
- **‘Rajan’ title:** first used for a Satavahana ruler in a **Nasik** inscription; not Junnar, Naneghat or Karle.

Caves

Cave	Location	Feature
Ajanta Cave 10	Ajanta	**Swetagaja Jataka** painting
Bhairavakonda	Nellore	**Eight** caves; **Saiva** centre
Guntupalli	Near Kamavarapukota, **Eluru**	**Rajagirika** school

Capitals and Ap Centres

Centre	Role / location
Pratishthana (Paithan)	**Principal western capital**, on the **Godavari**, Maharashtra
Dhanyakataka / Amaravati (Dharanikota)	Eastern capital after Rudradaman's attacks; Buddhist centre
Srikakulam (Krishna dt)	Traditional early Andhra capital
Kotilingala (Karimnagar, Telangana)	Claimed early political centre
Mahishmati	Capital of subordinate **Anupa**

- First capital is often thought to be Amaravati, but the real capital was **Paithan**.
- **AP sites**: Amaravati, Bhattiprolu, Ghantasala, Jaggayyapeta, Nagarjunakonda.
- Shift to Dhanyakataka made the **Krishna valley** the dynasty's centre.

Coins and Economy

- **Satakarni I**: first silver coins.
- **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi** and **Yajna Sri**: **ship-motif** coins = maritime power.
- **Jogalthambi**: restruck Nahapana coins = proof of victory.

Number Game and Quick Revision

Item	Fact
Matsya Purana	30 kings, 456 years
Vayu / Vishnu	17 kings, 272 years
Hala	17th king
Gautamiputra	23rd, c. 106-130 CE
Longest reign	Satakarni II, 56 years
Last king	Pulomavi III, 30th
Nasik Prasasti	19th year of Pulumavi
Gathasaptasati	700 verses

Item	Fact
Gift to monks	100 nivartanas
Bhairava konda	8 caves

FIRST / LAST / SPECIAL FACTS

- Founder: **Simuka**; first inscription: **Krishna**; first silver coins: **Satakarni I**.
- First Telugu word: **Nagabu** (Amaravati).
- Metronymics begin: **Gautamiputra**.
- Last ruler: **Pulomavi III**.

Appsc Previous Year Questions

Examination	Question Area
Group 2 Mains 2025, Paper 1	Inscription; earliest inscriptions in Maharashtra
Group 2 Mains 2025, Paper 1	Coins; dynasty – period (two questions)
Group 2, 2019	Devi Naganika as regent
Group 2, 2017	Bellary theory, Gathasaptasati, Kodavali, Anupa–Mahishmati
Group 2, 2012	Sukthankar – “not the same”
Group 2, 2011	Last ruler Pulomavi III
Group 2, 2008	Nasik victories; metronymics
APPSC 2000	Territory regained from Nahapana

High-probability Mcq Traps

VERY IMPORTANT

1. Nasik Prasasti: issued by **Gautami Balasri** in **Pulumavi’s** reign, not by Gautamiputra.
2. **Naneghat** = Naganika (Satakarni I), not Gautamiputra.
3. Gathasaptasati does **not** give early history.
4. Gautamiputra is the **23rd** king, not 28th.
5. Matsya = **30** kings; Vayu = 17.
6. Metronymics start with **Gautamiputra**; succession still patriarchal.
7. Kodavali = **Chanda Satakarni**; Myakadoni = **Bellary**.
8. Dakshinapathapati = **Satakarni I**; Dakshinapatheshwara = **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi**.
9. Junnar = **Ayama**, a Kshaharata record, not Satavahana.
10. Lilavati was **Hala’s** queen, not Gautamiputra’s.

Old notes — row 47: Satavahana Administration, Economy, Coinage and Prakrit Literature (hala's Gathasaptasati)

Nature of Kingship and the State

- King = **upholder of dharma** (Dharmashastra ideal); kingship **hereditary and patriarchal**.
- Power **more decentralised than the Mauryas**: **Mauryan-style officers (Amatya, Mahamatra)** beside **local feudatories**.
- King's council = **Mantri Parishad**.
- **Queen mothers**: **Naganika** – regent for her minor sons, issued **Naneghat**; **Gautami Balasri** – issued the **Nasik** inscription in her grandson **Pulumavi's** reign.

Ruler / queen	Title / contribution
Gautamiputra Satakarni	Metronymics begin with him; **Ekabrahmana**, **Varnasankarya-nirodhaka** (stopper of mixing of varnas)
Kuntala Satakarni (13th king)	Made **Sanskrit the royal language**; court of **Gunadhya** and **Sarvavarma**; Katantra composed for him
Hala (17th king)	**Kavivatsala**; compiled the **Gathasaptasati**; honoured poets **Kumarila** and **Sripalita**; reign = golden age of Prakrit
Yajna Sri	Called **Trisamudradhipati** (lord of three seas) in Banabhatta's **Harshacharita**

Administrative Units and Officers

Units

Unit	Meaning	Head
Rashtra	Province	—
Ahara	District / largest administrative division (PYQ key)	**Amatya** (distant aharas: **Mahasenadhipathulu**)
Vishaya	Sub-division	—
Gulma	Cluster of villages / military outpost	**Gulmika (Gaulmika)**
Grama	Village (lowest unit)	Village head; **Gramani** over **5 or 10 villages**

- Hierarchy: **Rashtra → Ahara → Vishaya → Grama**.
- Aharas in inscriptions: Satavahani, **Govardhana** (most prominent, Nasik inscription), **Sopara**, Mamala, Kodura, Vaijayanti.

Officers and Bodies

Officer / body	Role
Amatya	Minister / district officer who ran the Aharas; not hereditary, often transferred
Mahamatra	Special officer; also ran Aharas
Visvamaatyulu	Consulted for important decisions
Rajaamatyas	Advisors
Mahaamatyas	Special officers
Mahasenapati / Senapati	Day-to-day military administration of regions (king = supreme commander)
Gulmika (Gaulmika)	Head of a **gulma** – **military outpost** officer in rural areas (Myakadoni); ⚠ APPSC key (2008) gave village headman
Gramika	**Village headman**
Heranika	**Treasurer**
Bhandagarika	Stores
Rajjugahaka	**Land surveyor**
Pradeshika	Police
Pattikapala	Drafted land-grant inscriptions
Akshapatakas	Kept records of the king’s orders
Mahatalavara	Commander of border provinces

- Village headships, often held by military officers, became **hereditary** → helped **feudalism** grow.

Urban Administration

- **Nigama Sabha** = urban council that ran **cities/towns, not villages** (G2 2008); members **Gahapatis**; named in the **Bhattiprolu** inscription.
- **Gahapati (Gaaha Pati)** = representative of farmers; also part of urban administration.
- Towns: **Barukaccha, Sopara, Kalyan, Govardhana**, Pratishthana, Kondapur, Dhanyakataka, Vijayapuri, Nasik.

Nigama Sabha = cities; Gulma = group of villages; Heranika = treasurer, not surveyor.

Feudatories and Army

Feudatories

Title	Feature / region
Raja	Highest feudatory; **could issue coins**
Maharathis	Hereditary; collected and remitted taxes; **western Deccan**
Mahabhojas	Powerful local chiefs; **Konkan** (not Eastern Bengal); inscriptions omit the emperor's name → near-independence
Mahatalavaras / Mahasenadhipatis	Generals of **border provinces**; later feudal lords

- Grading: **Raja > Mahabhoja > Senapati**.
- Semi-feudal **Samanta rajyas** paid tribute and sent troops: **Chutus – Mysore; Kuras – Kolhapur; Ikshvakus – Vijayapuri**. Many became independent after the fall.

Army and Camps

- **Pliny**: **1,00,000 infantry, 2,000 cavalry, 1,000 elephants**; chaturanga bala plus archers.
- **Amaravati sculptures**: infantry in front, cavalry and elephants on flanks, archers at the rear.

Term	Meaning
Kataka	**Permanent** military camp / fortified centre in cities
Skandhavara	**Temporary** campaign camp

APPSC G1 2024: Katakas and Skandhavaras = military camps that served as **administrative centres** when the king was present (not tax-free monk villages or rock-cut areas).

Taxes and Tax-free Land Grants

Term	Meaning
Bhaga	Land revenue; king's share of harvest = **1/6**
Kara	General levy
Deya-meya (Bhodga, Deeva Meeya)	King's share of peasant produce, **in kind**
Karukara	Tax on **artisans** and professionals (sistu)
Moturpha	Tax on trades
Vetti	Forced labour

- **Land revenue** = chief income; plus tribute from feudatories and trade taxes.
- **FIRST**: Satavahanas made the **first tax-free land grants (agraharas)** to **Brahmanas and Buddhist monks**, with immunities; a root of the early-medieval feudal order.
- **Naneghat**: Satakarni I gave land, cows (**godhana**) and gold to Brahmanas.
- **Gautamiputra**: village at **Tirasmri** to monks + 100 nivartanas of his own land.
- **Immunity**: royal officers and soldiers could not enter granted land.

Bhaga = land revenue (1/6); Karukara = artisans' tax.

Agriculture and Guilds

Agriculture

- Cultivation spread in the **Krishna-Godavari** basin; **paddy transplantation**; main crops **rice and cotton**.
- Irrigation: **ghatiyantras**, made by the **Udayantrika** guild.

AP centre	Product
Gudur u	Fine cotton
Vinuko nda	Metal
Palnad u	Diamonds
Guntu palli	**Copper and iron** (not gold)
Karimn agar-Waran gal	Iron ore

Guilds (Srenis / Srenulu)

- **Shreni** = guild of traders/artisans of one craft; fixed work rules, quality, prices, wages; controlled members.
- Head: **Shreshthi (Sethi)**; **18 guilds** in Satavahana inscriptions.
- Guilds existed in **north and south India**, not only the north; not registered with a central authority.
- Acted as **banks**: took deposits, paid interest, including to monasteries; interest **12%** (APPSC 2019).

Guild	Craft
Kolika	**Weavers**
Padhika	**Carpenters** (butchers = Katika)
Vadhaki	**Carpenters**
Tailika / Tilapishaka	Oil pressers
Udayantrika	Water-machines
Gandhika	Perfumers
Kulara / Kularika	Potters
Malakara	Florists
Sarthavaha	Long-distance / foreign traders

- **Nasik inscription of Ushavadatta (Rishabhadatta)**, Nahapana's son-in-law: **2,000 karshapanas** with the **Govardhana weavers' guild** at **1% a month = 12% a year** (robes for monks); **1,000** at **3/4% a month** for other needs.
- Later guilds: **Nigamalu** = Ikshvaku trade guilds; **Chitrameli** = medieval agriculturists' guild.

Trade Routes, Centres and Ports

Inland Routes

- **Ujjain → Bharuch (Barygaza)** via **Paithan and Tagara**.
- **Kalyan → Naneghat pass → Junnar → Paithan**: main route from the west coast into the Deccan.
- **Tagara (Ter)**: emporium on the route from Pratishthana to the **east coast**; **Pratishthana**: capital and inland centre on the Godavari; **Vengi**: trade centre.
- Satavahanas = road builders, “**Mahapatha nirmatalu**”.

Ports

Port / centre	Identification
Maisolia	**Machilipatnam**; textiles (Ptolemy)
Kantakossyla	**Ghantasala**
Koddura (Koduru)	Gudur area, Krishna; **only east-coast port in the Periplus**
Dhanyakataka	Amaravati / Dharanikota
Kalingapatnam	Srikakulam coast
Bharukachha	Bharuch, Gujarat; Satavahana after Nahapana's defeat
Sopara, Kalyan	West coast, **Maharashtra**; Kalyan destroyed by the Sakas (Periplus)
Motupalli	Rose later under the **Kakatiyas** (Eastern Chalukya context) – not Satavahana

- Satavahanas were pioneers of **west-coast** trade (Bharukachha, Sopara, Kalyan, Vyjayantipura).

Place	Other name
Vijayapuri	Nagarjunakonda
Vengipuram	Pedavegi (near Eluru)
Kodur u	Gudur
Bhattiprolu	Pratipalapuram
Motupalli	Desiyakondapattanam
Nagalapuram (Palnadu)	Hala

- Buddhist viharas grew beside trade centres; **Bhavaviveka** = acharya at **Dhanyakataka** (Amaravati) vihara (G2 2019).

Satavahana ports = Kodur, Kalyan, Sopara; Motupalli is later.

Indo-roman Trade

Source	Author / language	Fact
Natural History	**Pliny** (Latin)	Drain of Roman gold for fine cloth; about **12.5 million denarii a year**
Periplus	Anonymous Greek	**Arikamedu** = "market street of the Romans" (east coast, near Puducherry)
Exports	Imports	
Muslin (Mallaselai), silk, gems, **pearls, diamonds, ivory, spices**, pepper, Wootz steel	Wine (Italy, Arabia), copper, gold and silver coins, gold (Malaya, Sumatra), silk and **camphor (China)**	

- **Roman coins** at **Bhattiprolu**, many at **Nagarjunakonda**; gold coins at Attirala, **Salihundam**, Vijayawada, **Vinukonda**, Nellore.
- **Constantine** gold coin at **Kudali Sangameswaram** (Alampur) = later period.
- Coins of **Pulomavi and Yagnasri** show thriving sea trade.
- Roman trade **peaked** under the Satavahanas (1st c. BCE–3rd c. CE) and **declined after them**.

- Egypt (Feb 2026): ~**30 Indian inscriptions** (Tamil-Brahmi, Prakrit, Sanskrit) of the Indo-Roman phase found in **Theban tombs**.

G2 2025 assertion-reason: “trade flourished after the Satavahanas” is false.

Coinage

Metals

- Metals: **lead (most common), copper, bronze, silver, potin**.
- **No gold coins**: gold used only as bullion. **Nickel** not used.
- Currency **karshapana** in copper and silver; **1 suvarna (gold) = 35 karshapanas** (Rishabhadatta inscription).

Iron coins with thin copper coating = **Ikshvakus** (Krishna-Guntur; APPSC key), not Satavahanas.

Coin Types

Type	Issuer / fact
Ship-motif	**Vasishthiputra Pulumavi** and **Yajna Sri Satakarni** (ship with anchor – trade with Siam, Java, Borneo)
Portrait coins	Indigenous innovation; began with **Gautamiputra**; silver portraits common after him
Restruck	Gautamiputra restruck Nahapana's silver – **Jogalthambi hoard, 13,270 coins**
Bilingual	Later silver portraits: **Prakrit + a Dravidian language** (G2 2025)

- Motifs: elephant, horse, lion, camel, chaitya, dharmachakra; reverse **Ujjain symbol** (cross with four circles).
- **Kotilingala (Karimnagar)**: coins of founder **Simuka**, legend "**Siri Chimuka Sata**"; **Kondapur (Medak)** = mint site.
- Legends in **Prakrit, Brahmi** (not Kharosthi).

After the Satavahanas

- **No later ruler issued ship-motif coins** (G2 2025 key).
- **Ikshvakus**: lead coins – **Phanigiri** pot of **3,730** lead coins (elephant obverse, Ujjain symbol reverse; 2024).
- **Pallavas**: lead, copper and bronze coins with **bull and lion** symbols.

Language and Script

- **Official / royal / inscriptional language = Prakrit** (G2 2011); script **Brahmi**; earliest stone inscription = Prakrit.
- Satavahanas = **nurturers of Prakrit** (more than Sanskrit); Sanskrit grew alongside Prakrit and folk languages; later Mahayana texts in Sanskrit.
- **Desi Bhaasha** (common people) = **Dravidian** family.

Dynasty	Official language
Satavahanas	Prakrit
Early Ikshvakus	Prakrit
Salankayanas	**Sanskrit** replaced Prakrit (of 8 inscriptions, 5 Sanskrit, 3 Prakrit)
Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi	Telugu
Andhra Pradesh	Telugu from **1966** (not 1956)
FIRST	Fact
First complete Sanskrit inscription	**Junagadh** of Rudradaman
First Telugu word	"**Nagabu**" (Amaravati)
Telugu word in Myakadoni (8th year of Pulumavi, Bellary)	"**Vepuru**"
Desi words in Gathasaptasati	**Atta, Addam, Potta, Pilla**, Padi, Pandi, Ammi, Tuppu

- Telugu script from **Brahmi** via Bhattiprolu and Telugu-Kannada scripts; Pali = most early Buddhist literature.
- "**Italian of the East**" (Telugu, words end in vowels): phrase from **Niccolo de Conti**, used by the British.
- **Gundaram forest** (Jayashankar Bhupalpally, Telangana; Jun 2026): new Satavahana-era Prakrit-Brahmi inscriptions on divisions, chiefs, land grants.
- **Sanskrit under the later Ikshvakus:** inscriptions of later Ikshvaku kings such as Ehuvala Chamtamula at Nagarjunakonda are in Sanskrit, so Sanskrit became prominent under the Ikshvakus after their early Prakrit records.

Society and Women

- **Chaturvarna** worked (G2 2008); **Sakas and Yavanas absorbed**; Brahmanical ideology not abolished.
- Occupational groups: Gandhikas, weavers, oil pressers, potters, florists, sarthavahas.
- **Religion**: kings followed **Vedic** religion (Ashvamedha); **queens and women donors** supported **Buddhism** (Gautami Balasri gave a vihara).
- **Shipping**: seafaring merchants in Gathasaptasati + ship coins.

Women

- Women **respected**: matronymics; queens' inscriptions; **independent donations at Bharhut, Sanchi, Amaravati** without naming husbands or fathers; women artisans, merchants and poets.
- Society still patriarchal; **Kamasutra** records **vetti** by women.

"Women were looked down upon" = incorrect option (G2 2008).

Social Picture in the Gathasaptasati

- Rural life, **sugar and jaggery**; **sati**; **no child marriage**; prostitution; **hanging of criminals**.
- **Brundagana** (group dances, choral singing); house-wall paintings; plight of **wives of seafaring merchants**.
- **Aradalam:** facial paste used by **dancers** (Gathasaptasati, Amaravati sculptures).
- Arts had a **public aspect**.

Literature

Work	Author	Language / note
Gathasaptasati	**Hala** (Kavivatsala)	**Maharashtri Prakrit**; **700 gathas**
Brihatkatha	**Gunadhya**	**Paishachi Prakrit**; 7 lakh verses, 7 stories; original lost
Katantra Vyakaranam	**Sharvavarma (Sarvavarma)**	Short **Sanskrit grammar**
Lilavati Parinayam	**Kutuhala**	Maharashtri Prakrit
Samayasara	**Kundakundacharya**	Jain treatise
Yogasara	**Acharya Nagarjuna** (G2 2017)	—
Prajnaparamita (shastra)	**Nagarjuna**	Sanskrit; Mahayana
Kathasaritsagara	**Somadeva** of Kashmir (not Jain Somadeva Suri)	Sanskrit
Brihatkatha Manjari	Kshemendra	Sanskrit
Mricchakatika	Shudraka	—

Gathasaptasati and Hala

- Anthology of **700 Prakrit gathas** on **love, romance, rural life, nature** (G2 2025); opens with a prayer to **Shiva**.
- **Most important literary source** for Satavahana **society** – not political history.
- **Women contributors**: **Anulakshmi, Anupalabdha, Reva (Revati), Madhavi** (G2 2017).
- **First** work covering all **Navarasas**; Desi words = earliest traces of Telugu.

Brihatkatha, Katantra and Lilavati

- **Legend**: Gunadhya, court poet of **Kuntala Satakarni**, quarrelled with **Sarvavarma** over how fast the king could learn Sanskrit; he lost, gave up Sanskrit and wrote in **Paishachi**.
- Brihatkatha mentions **slavery**; Sanskrit versions: **Kathasaritsagara** (Somadeva), **Brihatkathamanjari** (Kshemendra).
- **Katantra**: written so **Kuntala Satakarni** could learn Sanskrit quickly.
- **Lilavati Parinayam**: Hala marries **Sinhala princess Lilavati** at the **Bhimeswara temple, Draksharamam** (Saptagodavari); also says a Satavahana king patronised Nagarjuna.

Nagarjuna’s Works

Work	Addressee / nature
Suhrullekha	Letter to a **Satavahana king**
Ratnavali	~500-verse letter to a **Satavahana king**
Mulamadhyamakakarika	Verse treatise on Madhyamika

700 gathas = Gathasaptasati; 7 lakh verses in 7 stories = Brihatkatha. Brihatkatha is Paishachi, not Sanskrit.

- **Somadeva Suri** (Jain, 10th c.; not Somadeva of Kashmir): wrote the Sanskrit champu **Yashastilaka** (c. 959 CE) at **Gangadhara** in the **Vemulavada Chalukya** kingdom, and **Nitivakyamrita** on statecraft.

Number Game and Quick Revision

Item	Fact
Bhaga	1/6
Guild interest	12% (1% a month)
Ushavadatta deposits	2,000 + 1,000 karshapanas
Gold : karshapana	1 : 35
Guilds in inscriptions	18
Gramani	5 or 10 villages
Pliny’s army	1,00,000 / 2,000 / 1,000
Jogalthambi hoard	13,270 coins
Gathasaptasati	700 gathas

Item	Fact
Brihatkatha	7 lakh verses, 7 stories
Kuntala / Hala	13th / 17th king

FIRST / LAST / SPECIAL FACTS

- First tax-free land grants: Satavahanas.
- First portrait coins: Gautamiputra.
- First Telugu word: Nagabu; first complete Sanskrit inscription: Junagadh.
- Last ship-motif coins: Satavahanas (none after them).
- Special: no gold coins; lead most common.
- Land grants, guild banking and Roman trade = base of **Deccan urbanisation**.

Appsc Previous Year Questions

Examination	Question Area
Group 2 Mains 2025, Paper 1	Literary work – book – author (Gathasaptasati, Brihatkatha)
Group 2 Mains 2025, Paper 1	Coins; trade after the Satavahanas (A-R)
Group 1 Prelims 2024, Paper 1	Katakas and Skandhavaras
Group 2, 2019	Guild interest 12%; Bhavaviveka
Group 2, 2017	Women contributors; Yogasara; Gathasaptasati not political
Group 2, 2011	Official language Prakrit
Group 2, 2008	Gulmika, Nigama Sabha, Kavivatsala, women’s status

High-probability Mcq Traps

VERY IMPORTANT

- 1. Satavahanas issued **no gold coins**; lead most common; nickel not used.
- 2. Iron coins with copper coating = **Ikshvakus**.
- 3. Ship coins = **Vasishthiputra Pulumavi and Yajna Sri**; none after.
- 4. **Nigama Sabha** ran cities, not villages.
- 5. **Gulmika** = head of a military **gulma**; **Gramika** = village headman; **Heranika** = treasurer.
- 6. Brihatkatha = **Paishachi**, not Sanskrit.
- 7. Official language = **Prakrit**, script **Brahmi**.
- 8. **Mahabhojas** = Konkan, not Eastern Bengal.
- 9. **Motupalli** is not a Satavahana port.
- 10. Roman trade **declined** after the Satavahanas.

Old notes — row 48: Satavahana Art and Architecture – Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda and Rock-cut Caves

Stupa, Chaitya and Vihara – Basic Terms

- **Stupa** = mound; usually a **repository of relics**; a votive and commemorative structure in Buddhism.
- Stupa tradition **predates Buddhism** (not Buddhist in origin); the Vedic funeral practice **pitramedha** collected ashes.
- **Pradakshina patha** = circular path around the stupa; **Garbhagriha** = where a deity's image is installed (temple term).
- Satavahana stupa, chaitya and vihara forms became the **base of later Hindu temple architecture**; the **first structural Hindu temples** in Andhra came under the **Ikshvakus**.

Structure Types

Term	Meaning
Chaitya (Chaitya Shala / Chaitya Griha)	Prayer hall / place of worship and assembly; rectangular hall ending in an **apse** (horseshoe plan), pillars, barrel-vaulted roof, stupa at the far end
Chaitya window	**Horseshoe-shaped** opening on the facade
Vihara	Monastery; monks' shelter in the **rainy season**; cells around a central hall (**Madhyashala**)
Uposatha	Monks' meeting in the vihara hall **every 15 days**
Arama	Complex of stupa + vihara + chaitya + school together

Stupa Types

Type	Meaning	Examples
Dhatugarbha (saririka)	Bodily relics	Nagarjunakonda, Amaravati, Jaggayyapeta, Salihundam, Bhattiprolu
Uddeshika	Devotional / memorial, no relics	–
Paribhogika	Objects or texts used by the Buddha or monks	–

Andhra Stupa Features – Ayaka Platform

- **4 ayaka platforms** project at the 4 cardinal points; each carries **5 ayaka pillars** = the **Pancha Kalyanakas** (five great events of Buddha's life).
- The ayaka platform with ayaka pillars is **unique to Andhra**: Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda, Ghantasala, Bhattiprolu, Jaggayyapeta – **not** the western Deccan caves.
- "Platform with Ayaka (Aryak) pillars" = **Amaravati stupa** (UPPSC 2022).
- Other ayaka symbols: **Purnakumbha**, Vinayaka.
- Nagarjunakonda ayaka inscription: "**Samma Sambhudha Dhatu Parigahita**".

Buddha’s Life → Symbol

Event	Symbol
Birth	**Lotus and bull**
Great Departure (Renunciation)	**Horse**
Enlightenment	**Bodhi (peepal) tree**
First sermon (Mrigadava / Sarnath)	**Wheel** (wheel with deer)
Mahaparinirvana	**Stupa**
Meditation (deep concentration under Bodhi tree)	**Empty seat**

Amaravati Mahachaitya

- Ancient **Dhanyakataka** (Amaravati-Dharanikota), on the **Krishna**, Guntur/Palnadu region; Satavahana capital and today’s AP capital.
- A **Dhatugarbha** stupa built over the **Buddha’s relics**; **biggest stupa in AP** (G2 2019); Satavahana queens built **chaityas for Buddhist monks** (the kings were Brahmanical).

Phases and Patrons

Phase	Patron / act
Origin (Ashoka's age)	**Mahadeva Bhikshu** (sent by Ashoka; first Buddhist teacher in Andhra) enshrined Buddha's bone powder in a copper urn; Naga king **Nagashoka** helped build it at Dharanikota
Enlargement	**Vasishthiputra Satakarni** – limestone sculptures + **vedika**
Inscription	**Pulumavi II** (on a gateway pillar); also "Nagabu"; stupa of the Chaitika Sangha
Stone railing / prakara (enclosing wall)	**Acharya Nagarjuna**, in **Yajnasri Satakarni's** time (APPSC 2001 key)
Final enlargement	**Ikshvakus**

- Artisan **Siddhattha** gifted five ayaka pillars at the eastern gate of the Mahachaitya.

Discovery and Dispersal

Person	Work	Year
Col. Colin Mackenzie (first Surveyor General of India)	Identified Amaravati; relics to London and Madras	**1797**
Robert Sewell	Excavated Amaravati	**1877**
James Fergusson	*Tree and Serpent Worship*; called it the "**Epitome of Indian architecture**"	–

- Sculptures today: **British Museum, London**; **Amaravati Museum**; Government Museum, **Chennai**.
- **Amaravati Buddhist Stupa** is on India's **UNESCO tentative list**; Lepakshi (Veerabhadra Temple, monolithic Nandi) was added in 2022.

Amaravati "next only to Sanchi in size" was marked incorrect (UPSC 2026 key). Vedika sculptures = Vasishthiputra Satakarni; stone railing / prakara = Nagarjuna in Yajnasri's time; final = Ikshvakus.

Nagarjunakonda

- Ancient names **Vijayapuri** / **Sriparvata**; capital of the **Ikshvakus**; guardian (tutelary) deity **Hariti** (APPSC 2012).
- **N. Venkataramanayya** identified "**Sri Parvataswamy**" with the Buddha; **Kielhorn** with **Mallikarjuna of Srisailam**. ⚠ APPSC key (2019) gave Kielhorn.
- More than **30 stupas**, viharas and apsidal chaityas; **Ikshvaku queens** were major donors; a **Sinhalese vihara** for Sri Lankan monks.
- **Yajna Sri Satakarni** built the **1,500-room Sriparvata Sangharama** for **Acharya Nagarjuna**; he is also a donor at **Chinaganjam** (Prakasam).
- **Golden Temple (Swarna Devalayam)** of **Ehuvala Shantamula** bears the **first Sanskrit inscription** of Andhra/South India; family deities of Chamtamula: **Virupakshapati** (Shiva), **Mahasena** (Kartikeya).
- Buddhism peaked under **Veerapurushadatta** (Ikshvaku records at Nagarjunakonda and Jaggayyapeta).

Excavation and Submergence

Event	Fact
Discovered	**A.R. Saraswati, 1926**
Excavated	**A.H. Longhurst, 1927–31**
Submerged	**Nagarjunasagar dam** reservoir drowned Vijayapuri
Today	Monuments rebuilt on the hilltop → **island museum** in the reservoir

- Sects at the site: Bahushrutiya, **Mahishasaka** (only Hinayana sect), Aparasaila; **Rajagirika** centre = **Guntupalli** (APPSC 2012 key; Sriparvatam in some lists).

Other Buddhist Sites of Andhra → District and Feature

Site	District / river	Feature
Bhattiprolu	Old Guntur dist. (Krishna delta)	**Oldest stupa in Andhra**; gold relic casket; Brahmi casket inscriptions (3rd c. BC) name **Raja Kubiraka** and the **Nigama-sabha**; excavated by **Alexander Rea, 1892**
Jaggayyapeta	Old Krishna dist.	Relic stupa (2nd c. BCE); **Mandhata** sculpture; excavated by **James Burgess, 1882**
Ghantasala	Krishna	Stupa at ancient port **Kantakossyla / Kantakasala**
Guntupalli	Eluru	Only rock-cut Buddhist cave site in Andhra; "**house viharas**"
Sankaram (Bojjannakonda, Lingalakonda)	Anakapalli	Rock-cut caves on twin hillocks; **horseshoe-shaped** caves; name from **Sangharama**
Thotlakonda, Bavikonda	Visakhapatnam	Hilltop monasteries; Bavikonda from 3rd c. BCE
Salihundam	Srikakulam (Gara mandal)	Relic stupa; flourished 2nd–3rd c. CE
Nelakondapalli	Khammam (Telangana)	Post-Satavahana mahastupa; bronze and marble Buddhas; **sculptor's workshop** (V.V. Krishna Sastry)

- **Bhairavakonda** (Nellore–Prakasam border): **8 rock-cut cave temples of Shiva** (7th–8th c., Pallava style) – Hindu, not Buddhist.
- Records: oldest in Andhra = **Bhattiprolu**; most ancient in India = **Bharhut**; largest in India = **Sanchi**; largest brick = **Kesariya**.
- Relic finds outside Andhra: **Piprahwa** casket with Brahmi "**Sakiyanam**"; **Dharmarajika, Taxila** bone-relic casket; **Devnimori** (Gujarat) monastery and stupa; **Kumrahar** Mauryan pillared hall.

Recent Excavations and Heritage Circuit

- **Thotlakonda**: spotted in an **Indian Navy aerial survey**; **1988–92** digs found the main stupa, votive stupas, **Satavahana and Roman coins**.
- **Phanigiri** (Suryapet, Telangana): Mahastupa, viharas, apsidal chaityagrihas; a **life-size stucco** sculpture; **2024** – pot of **3,730 lead coins** of the **Ikshvaku** period.
- **AP Buddhist International Tourism Circuit** (Socio-Economic Survey 2025-26): **Amaravati, Thotlakonda-Bavikonda, Bojjannakonda-Sankaram, Salihundam, Ghantasala** – for visitors from Japan, Korea, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Myanmar.
- **Kondapur (Sangareddy district, Telangana):** a fortified **Satavahana** town; finds include **terracotta figurines**, **beads** and many **Satavahana coins**. Its site museum is run by the **ASI**.

Ancient Names and Buddhist Sects

Ancient Name → Modern Site

Ancient	Modern
Dhanyakataka	Amaravati-Dharanikota
Vijayapuri / Sriparvata	Nagarjunakonda
Siddharthaka chaitya	**Gudivada** (G2 2008, G2 2011 keys); some lists give Guntupalli
Kantakossyla / Kantakasala	Ghantasala

Five Chaitika Sects (Mahasanghika branches; founder Mahadeva Bhikshu)

Sect	Centre
Purvasaila	Dhanyakataka (Amaravati)
Aparasaila	Sriparvata (Nagarjunakonda)
Uttarasaila	Jaggayyapeta
Rajagirika	**Guntupalli** (APPSC 2012 key); Sriparvatam in other lists
Siddharthika	Gudivada

G2 2011 “wrong pair” key marked **Guntupalli–Siddharthaka** wrong: Guntupalli = **Rajagirika** centre; Siddharthika **sect** and Siddharthaka **chaitya** = **Gudivada** (another key gave Uttarasaila–Jaggayyapeta).

- **Chaitika sects:** The five Chaitika sects (Purvasaila, Aparasaila, Uttarasaila, Rajagirika, Siddharthika) were branches of the **Mahasanghikas**, founded by **Mahadeva Bhikshu**.

Buddhist Acharyas

Acharya	Association
Nagarjuna	Sriparvata; **Madhyamika**, **Shunyavada**; patron Yajnasri Satakarni
Aryadeva	Nagarjuna’s disciple; *Chittasuddhi Prakaranam*
Bhavaviveka	Vihara at **Dhanyakataka**
Dinnaga	**Father of Buddhist logic**
Aryasangha	Founded **Yogachara**
Maitreyanatha	**Vijnanavada**
Padmasambhava	From Andhra; took **Vajrayana to Tibet**

Donors in Inscriptions

- Main donors: **women**, especially queens – Satavahana queens (**Gautami Balasri’s** vihara), Ikshvaku queens.
- Others: merchants, guilds, **Yavanas**, artisans (leather-worker **Dimikudu**); ivory-worker guilds at Amaravati.
- Western Deccan cave patrons: **Yavana merchants and Satavahana officials**.
- **“Tambaya Danamu / Dana”**: donation term at **Kotturu (Dhanadibbalu)** on the **Sarada river** near Yelamanchili, **Visakhapatnam district** (G2 2017 key).

Patron	Patronised
Satavahana and Ikshvaku queens	Buddhism
Salankayanas	Saivism (Chitrarathaswami)
Bethanamathya, early Kakatiya kings	Jainism
Rajaraja Narendra (E. Chalukya)	Nannayabhattu (began Telugu Mahabharata)
Veera Bhadra Reddy	Srinatha

Rock-cut Caves of the Satavahana Period

- Peak region: the **Sahyadris** (western Deccan) – Nasik, Naneghat, Karle, Bhaja, Kanheri, Junnar, Ajanta, Bedsa, Pitalkhora. Eastern Deccan chaityas and viharas are usually **structural**; Guntupalli is the rock-cut exception.

Site	Type / feature
Karle (Pune)	**Largest, most evolved Hinayana chaitya hall**; **12 dance-couple** sculptures; funded by Bhutapala, Chulaghosha; **Pulumavi II** donated a village
Bhaja	Early caves – **earlier than Karle**

Site	Type / feature
Nasik	**Viharas with Satavahana inscriptions**; chaitya funded by Vishnudatta (3,500 karshapanas)
Kanheri, Junnar	Large monastery complexes; chaityas
Pitalkhora (Aurangabad)	Early chaityas and viharas
Bedsa (Pune)	Chaitya with **bell-capital pillars**
Ajanta Caves 9, 10	Satavahana chaityas; Cave 10 = **Shwetagaja (Chhadanta) Jataka** painting (G2 2012)
Bagh (MP)	Cave viharas linked to the Satavahanas
Guntupalli (Eluru; earlier West Godavari)	Rock-cut chaityas and viharas; its chaitya = most ancient in Andhra

Some notes call Karle the most ancient chaitya; Bhaja is earlier. The Shwetagaja painting is at Ajanta, not Guntupalli.

Amaravati School of Art

- Region: lower **Krishna-Godavari** valley; period **2nd c. BCE–3rd c. CE** under the Satavahanas; **most mature phase under the Ikshvakus**.
- Material: **white Palnadu limestone** (marble-like); Ikshvaku phase also green stone.
- Style: **movement and emotion**; narrative reliefs of the **Jatakas** and the Buddha's life (Dharmachakra Parivartana, Buddha at Gaya, **3 group-dance scenes**, **Dimikudu offering a Purnakumbha**). The subject does not explain the style.
- **Early phase** aniconic: Bodhi tree, empty throne, footprints, wheel, stupa. **Later phase** Buddha in human form, seated on a lotus with dancing Gandharvas and Yakshas.
- Influence spread to **Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia**; one of India's three major ancient art schools.
- Ivory: **ivory carvers of Vidisha** carved the **Sanchi gateway**.

Feature	Gandhara	Mathura	Amaravati
Patrons	Kushanas	Shungas/Kushanas	Satavahanas, Ikshvakus
Material	**Grey-blue schist**, later stucco	**Spotted red sandstone**	**White limestone**
Influence	Greco-Roman	Indigenous	Indigenous
Sites	Taxila, Hadda	Mathura	Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda

Number Game and Quick Revision

Item	Fact
Ayaka platforms × pillars	4 × 5
Amaravati identified	1797 (Mackenzie)
Amaravati excavated	1877 (Sewell)

Item	Fact
Bhattiprolu excavated	1892 (Rea)
Nagarjunakonda discovered / excavated	1926 / 1927–31
Rooms in Nagarjuna’s vihara	1,500
Stupas at Nagarjunakonda	30+
Karle dance couples	12
Chaitika sects	5
Phanigiri lead coins (2024)	3,730
Bhairavakonda cave temples	8

FIRST / LAST / SPECIAL FACTS

- Oldest stupa in AP: **Bhattiprolu**; biggest: **Amaravati**.
- Only rock-cut Buddhist cave site in AP: **Guntupalli**.
- First Sanskrit inscription of South India: Nagarjunakonda Golden Temple.
- First Buddhist teacher in Andhra: Mahadeva Bhikshu.
- Chronology: Mackenzie 1797 → Sewell 1877 → Rea 1892 → Longhurst 1927.

Appsc Previous Year Questions

Examination	Question Area
APPSC 2001	Stone railing at Amaravati – Yajnasri Satakarni's time (Nagarjuna)
Group 2, 2002	Stupas built over Buddha's relics
Group 2, 2008 / 2011	Siddharthaka chaitya, sect–centre wrong pair
APPSC 2012	Hariti; Rajagirika centre; Shwetagaja Jataka (Ajanta)
Group 2, 2017	Tambaya Danamu
Group 2, 2019	Biggest stupa in AP; N. Venkataramanayya – Sri Parvataswamy

High-probability Mcq Traps

VERY IMPORTANT

1. **Bhattiprolu** = oldest in Andhra; **Bharhut** = most ancient in India; **Kesariya** = largest brick.
2. **Mackenzie 1797** (Amaravati) vs **Saraswati 1926** (Nagarjunakonda) vs **Rea 1892** (Bhattiprolu).
3. Vedika = **Vasishthiputra Satakarni**; stone railing / prakara (Yajnasri's time) = **Nagarjuna**; final enlargement = **Ikshvakus**.
4. Ayaka pillars are **Andhra-only**, not western Deccan.
5. **Karle** = largest Hinayana chaitya; **Bhaja** is earlier.
6. Siddharthaka **chaitya** = Gudivada (G2 2008 key); Guntupalli = **Rajagirika**.
7. **Hariti** = Ikshvaku guardian deity, not a Satavahana deity.
8. Amaravati "next only to Sanchi in size" = **incorrect**.
9. **Aryasangha** = Yogachara; **Maitreyanatha** = Vijnanavada; **Padmasambhava** = Vajrayana to Tibet.
10. Bhairavakonda caves are **Hindu (Shiva)**, not Buddhist.

Old notes — row 49: Satavahana Religious Conditions – Buddhism, Brahmanism and Royal Patronage

The Basic Rule – Kings Vedic, Queens Buddhist

- Satavahana **kings followed the Vedic religion**; **queens patronised Buddhism** (G2 2008). Royal women supported both Buddhism and Jainism.
- **Religious pluralism**: the dynasty performed the **Ashvamedha** and also supported **Amaravati** and **Nagarjunakonda**.
- Buddhism depended more on **public support than royal support**.
- **Prakrit** (people's language) helped Buddhism become a mass movement.

Patron	Religion
Satavahana rulers	**Vedic religion**
Satavahana queens	**Buddhism**
Pallavas	Rise of Brahmanism, downfall of Buddhism
Reddy period	**Veerasaivism** – the popular religion

Brahmanism – Vedic Sacrifices

Naneghat Inscription

Particular	Fact
Issuer	**Devi Naganika**, wife of **Satakarni I**
Her father	Maharathi **Tranakayiro** (Amgiya family)
Language	**Prakrit**
Yajnas	Satakarni I – **two Ashvamedhas + one Rajasuya**
Titles of Satakarni I	**Apratihatachakra**, **Dakshinapathapati**
Deities invoked	Indra, Vasudeva, Sankarshana, Surya, Chandra, Yama, Varuna

- **Vedic gods**: Indra, Yama, Varuna. **Bhagavata deities**: Vasudeva, Sankarshana.
- A queen performing such rites was unusual; she was effectively ruling as guardian of her son.

Other Vedic Evidence

- Yajna-performing kings: **Satakarni I, Satakarni II, Gautamiputra, Yajna Sri**.
- Names **Vedasri** and **Yajnasri** themselves show Vedic faith.
- **Nasik inscription** calls Gautamiputra **Agama nilaya** (abode of traditional learning).

Bhagavata Religion and Shiva Worship

Bhagavata Religion

- Originator **Krishna (Vasudeva)**, a **Vrishni (Satvat)** descendant from **Mathura**; son of **Devaki**, disciple of **Ghor Angirasa** (Chhandogya Upanishad).
- Centred at **Mathura**; reached Andhra under **Krishna** (the 2nd Satavahana king); called the "**Vasudeva religion**" by Hala's time.
- Gautamiputra's inscriptions carry **Bhagavata symbols**.

Gudimallam

- **Parasurameswara temple, Gudimallam** (Yerpedu mandal; Chittoor, now **Tirupati district**) = **oldest Shiva temple**; has the **oldest Shivalinga** of the Satavahana period (G2 2008).

Gudimallam distractors: Thondawada, Renigunta, Jogulamba.

Buddhism in Andhra – Arrival and Sects

- Buddhism reached Andhra in the **6th century BC**; local form called "**Andhra Buddhism**"; doctrine **Pratitya Samutpada**.
- Tibetan tradition: Buddha preached at Amaravati at the request of king **Subendran**.
- **Mahadeva Bhikshu** = first Buddhist acharya in Andhra; founded the **Chaityaka** sect (worship of chaityas).

Sect	Centre / note
Chaityaka (Chaityakavada)	Founder Mahadeva Bhikshu
Mahasanghika	**Dhanyakataka**; followers called Mahasanghis / Chaityakas
Purvasaila, Aparasaila	Hills around Dhanyakataka
Rajagirika	**Guntupalli** (G2 2012 key)
Bhadrayaniya	**Nasik**

- **Sriparvata = Nagarjunakonda**.
- **Sri Parvataswamy** identified with the **Buddha** by **N. Venkataramanayya** (G2 2019 key). The Vishnukundins' family deity was also Sriparvataswami.

Another APPSC key credits **Kielhorn** with describing Sri Parvataswamy as the Buddha; the G2 2019 key gave **N. Venkataramanayya**.

Royal and Queens' Gifts to the Sangha

Patron	Gift
Gautami Balasri	Cave vihara at **Nasik** for the **Bhadrayaniya** sect (for her son's recovery)
Gautamiputra Satakarni	Village at **Tirasmri** and 100 nivartanas to monks; toranas of Sanchi
Pulumavi II	Village to **Mahasanghika** monks at **Karle**
Yajna Sri Satakarni	**Sriparvata vihara / Mahachaitya** for Nagarjuna (**1,500 rooms**)
Krishna (2nd king)	**Nasik cave** for shramanas; appointed a **Dharma Mahamatra**

- **Nasik, Karle and Kanheri** caves are in **Maharashtra**.

Donors by Category

- **Queens** were key patrons; kings gave villages; **Yavana merchants** funded caves at Karle, Bhaja, Nasik, Junnar and Kanheri.
- **Guild banking**: guilds at **Nasik, Junnar, Kanheri** held money on deposit and paid **interest to monks** – e.g. **Ushavadata's** deposit with the **Govardhana weavers**.
- **Alluru inscription**: of the Ikshvaku **Virapurushadatta**; records the emperor's donations to many communities and institutions (G2 2017).

Alluru distractors: Karle, Veerapuram, Ramagiri.

Acharya Nagarjuna

Aspect	Details
Works	**Suhrullekha** ("friendly letter"), **Ratnavali**, Mulamadhyamakakarika

Aspect	Details
Philosophy	**Madhyamika / Sunyavada** (Soonya Vaadam) school of Mahayana
Patron	**Yajna Sri Satakarni** (close friend; Suhrullekha addressed to him)
Place	**Sriparvata (Nagarjunakonda)**

- **Lilavati Parinayam**: a Satavahana king supported him. **Kathasaritsagara**: Nagarjuna was killed by a Satavahana prince.

Jainism – Kundakundacharya

- **Kundakundacharya** preached **Syadvada** (G2 2008) and wrote **Samayasara**.

Other Facts

- **Gatha Saptasati** includes writing by women.
- **Mackenzie** discovered Amaravati; **Sewell** excavated it.
- AP anchors: **Amaravati/Dhanyakataka, Sriparvata, Gudimallam**.

Number Game and Quick Revision

Item	Fact
Ashvamedhas by Satakarni I	2 (+1 Rajasuya)
Rooms in Nagarjuna's vihara	1,500
Nivartanas gifted by Gautamiputra	100
Buddhism reached Andhra	6th century BC
Bhagavata reached Andhra	Under Krishna, 2nd king

FIRST / LAST / SPECIAL FACTS

- First Buddhist acharya in Andhra: **Mahadeva Bhikshu**.
- Oldest Shiva temple / linga: **Gudimallam**.
- Queen who issued an inscription on Vedic sacrifices: **Naganika**.

Appsc Previous Year Questions

Examination	Question Area
Group 2, 2008	Queens' patronage of Buddhism; Gudimallam; Syadvada – Kundakunda
Group 2, 2012	Rajagirika – Guntupalli
Group 2, 2017	Alluru inscription – Virapurushadatta
Group 2, 2019	Sri Parvataswamy = Buddha

High-probability Mcq Traps

VERY IMPORTANT

- 1. Kings **Vedic**, queens **Buddhist**.
- 2. Naneghat issuer = **Naganika**, not Gautami Balasri.
- 3. **Gautami Balasri** = Nasik vihara for **Bhadrayaniya**; **Pulumavi II** = Karle village to Mahasanghikas.
- 4. Indra/Yama/Varuna = Vedic; Vasudeva/Sankarshana = Bhagavata.
- 5. **Sunyavada = Nagarjuna**; **Syadvada = Kundakunda**.
- 6. Suhrullekha addressed to **Yajna Sri Satakarni**.
- 7. Alluru = **Virapurushadatta** (Ikshvaku), not a Satavahana king.
- 8. Rajagirika = **Guntupalli**; Mahasanghika = **Dhanyakataka**.
- 9. Gudimallam is in **Tirupati district** (earlier Chittoor).

Old PYQs and keys — row 46 (94)

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
1	Amaravati, the designated capital of Andhra Pradesh, was the historical capital of (1) Satavahana Dynasty (2) Krishna Dynasty (3) Buddhist Dynasty (4) Champakam Dynasty *APPSC AEE Civil & Mechanical Engineering General Studies & M*	**(1) Satavahana Dynasty**	
2	Who is considered the first ruler of Deccan? (1) Rastra Kutas (2) Chalukyas (3) The Cholas (4) Satavahanas *District Sainik Welfare Officers 2012*	**(4) Satavahanas**	
3	Who among the following is recognized as the founder of Satavahana rule? (1) Satakarni-I (2) Simukha (3) Kuntala Satakarni (4) Gautamiputra Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Simukha**	Simukha (Srimukha) founded Satavahana rule; Gautamiputra Satakarni was the greatest and Pulumavi-III the last.
4	Under whom did the Andhras gain independence from Mauryan rule? (1) Ikshvakus (2) Satavahanas (3) Shalankayanas (4) Vishnukundins *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Satavahanas**	The Andhrabhrityas of the Mauryas declared independence under Srimukha, the first Satavahana king.
5	The Satavahana kings who ruled Andhra belonged to which caste? (1) Kshatriyas (2) Naidu (3) Reddys (4) Brahmins *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Brahmins**	The Nasik inscription calls Gautamiputra Satakarni ‘Eka Brahmana’, so they are regarded as Brahmins.
6	The oldest of the Deccan rulers? (1) The Chalukyas (2) Rashtrakutas (3) Cholas (4) Satavahanas *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Satavahanas**	The Satavahanas, ruling roughly from 200 BC to 200 AD, were the oldest Deccan dynasty.
7	The first dynasty which ruled Andhra was: (1) Chola (2) Satavahana (3) Eastern Chalukya (4) Rashtrakuta *APPSC Group-1 PYQ*	**(2) Satavahana**	The Satavahanas were the first major dynasty to rule over the Andhra region.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
8	The inscriptions of early Satavahana kings were found in (1) Maharashtra (2) Andhra (3) Karnataka (4) Telangana *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(1) Maharashtra**	The earliest Satavahana inscriptions Naneghat (Queen Naganika) and the Nashik caves-lie in present-day Maharashtra, the dynasty's original core region. Only later did the political centre shift eastward to Andhra (Amaravati, Dharanikota).
9	Simuka was the founder of which of the following dynasties? (1) Chera (2) Chola (3) Pandya (4) Satavahana *UPPSC (Mains) 2008*	**(4) Satavahana**	Simuka (Srimukha) was the first king and founder of the Satavahana dynasty; the Chera, Chola and Pandya dynasties are unrelated Tamil kingdoms.
10	Which among the following was the earliest dynasty? (1) Chalukya (2) Pallava (3) Rashtrakuta (4) Satavahana *UP UDA/LDA (Pre) 2001*	**(4) Satavahana**	The Satavahanas (c. 200 BC–200 AD) were the oldest Deccan dynasty, earlier than the Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas and Pallavas, which came centuries later.
11	The first dynasty to rule Andhra? (1) Cholas (2) Satavahanas (3) Eastern Chalukyas (4) Rashtrakutas *APPSC Group-I Re-exam 2010*	**(2) Satavahanas**	The Satavahanas brought all the Telugu regions under one rule for the first time.
12	The Satavahana kings maintained the social structure based on the Varnashramadharma. At the same time there was another classification prevalent during the period based on the social status of the people. Arrange the classes given below from the highest status to lowest status. A. Maharathas B. Mahamatras C. Ghandikas D. Lohavanijas (1) A, B, C and D (2) A, D, C and B (3) B, A, C and D (4) C, B, A and D *Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III (Panchayat Secretary Gr*	**(1) A, B, C and D**	
13	Who propounded the theory that 'Andhras and Satavahanas are not the same'? (1) R.G. Bhandarkar (2) V.S. Sukthankar (3) P.T. Srinivasa Iyengar (4) V.A. Smith *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) V.S. Sukthankar**	V.S. Sukthankar proposed that the Andhras and Satavahanas were not one and the same and argued for a Kannada (Bellary) origin.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
14	Identify the scholar who argued that the Satavahanas were not Andhras. (1) R.G. Bhandarkar (2) V.S. Sukthankar (3) Rapson (4) Dr. Gopalachari *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) V.S. Sukthankar**	Sukthankar argued that the Satavahanas were not Andhras and placed their original home in the Kannada (Bellary) region.
15	According to the Macedonian inscription, who among the following said that the Satavahanas belonged to Bellary? (1) V. V. Mirashi (2) R. G. Bhandarkar (3) V. S. Sukthankar (4) S. A. JogLaker *APPSC Group-II Mains 2017*	**(2) R. G. Bhandarkar**	The eminent historian R. G. Bhandarkar proposed the Bellary Theory regarding the origin of the Satavahanas. Based on inscriptional evidence and historical interpretation, he suggested that the early Satavahanas originated from the Bellary region. Although later historians proposed alternative theories placing their origin in the Godavari valley or
16	Who propounded the theory that ‘Andhras and Satavahanas are not the same’? (1) R. G. Bhandarkar (2) V. S. Sukthankar (3) P. T. Srinivasa Iyengar (4) V. A. Smith *APPSC Group-II 2012*	**(2) V. S. Sukthankar**	Historian V. S. Sukthankar argued that the Andhras mentioned in the Puranas and the Satavahanas referred to in inscriptions were not identical. This interpretation became an important historiographical debate in ancient Indian history. However, many later historians have accepted that the Satavahanas were the Andhra rulers (Andhra Bhrityas) mention
17	Identify the scholar who argued that Satavahanas were not Andhras and “Andhrabhrityas” were? (1) R.G. Bhandarkar (2) V.N. Sukthankar (3) Rapson (4) Dr. Gopalachari *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) V.N. Sukthankar**	V.N. Sukthankar propounded the theory that the Satavahanas were not Andhras and that the term “Andhrabhrityas” mentioned in the Puranas referred to a different group. This view generated considerable debate among historians. Later scholars such as Dr. Gopalachari argued that the Satavahanas were indeed Andhras. Hence, the correct answer is Option (
18	Who among the following located Satavahanas in Ballari (Bellary) district on the basis of Myakadoni Inscription (1) V.V.Mirashi (2) R.G.Bhandarker (3) V.S.Sukthankar (4) S.A.Joglekar *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(3) V.S.Sukthankar**	V.S. Sukthankar held that the Satavahanas were not the Andhras and placed their home in the Bellary region on the basis of the Myakadoni inscription. Bhandarkar is the tempting option but held that Andhras and Satavahanas were the same.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
19	Who of the following scholars argued that Satavahanas were not Andhras but Andhra-bhrityas? (1) R.G. Bhandarkar (2) V.N. Suktankar (3) Rapson (4) Dr. Gopalachari *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) V.N. Suktankar**	Sukthankar argued that the Satavahanas were Andhra-bhrityas (Mauryan vassals) rather than original Andhras.
20	Which among the following Puranas is considered as a sourcebook of Indian Painting? (1) Vishnudharmottara Purana (2) Matsya Purana (3) Agni Purana (4) Markandeya Purana *APPSC Animal Husbandry Department General Studies & Mental A*	**(1) Vishnudharmottara Purana**	
21	Which of the following dynasty is identified with the Andhras as mentioned in Puranas? (1) Ikshavakus (2) Satvahanas (3) Kadambas (4) Cheras *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(2) Satvahanas**	
22	The author of Brihadkatha, Gunadhya was a scholar in the court of the Satavahana king? (1) Simuka (2) Satakarni I (3) Satakarni II (4) Hala *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(4) Hala**	
23	The famous ‘Matsya Purana’ was compiled during the reign of which of the following Satavahana kings? (1) Satakarni-I (2) Gautamiputra Satakarni (3) Hala (4) Yajnasri Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Yajnasri Satakarni**	The Matsya Purana is believed to have been compiled during Yajnasri Satakarni’s reign.
24	Which religious faith did Yajna Sri Satakarni belong to? (1) Jain (2) Buddhism (3) Shaivism (4) Vaishnavism *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**— no key**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
25	According to mythology, who was the last of the Satavahana kings? (1) Sivashri Satakarni (2) Vijayashri (3) Chandrashri (4) Third Pulomavi *APPSC Group-II 2011*	**(4) Third Pulomavi**	According to the Puranas (mythological sources), Pulumavi III (Third Pulomavi) was the last ruler of the Satavahana dynasty. After his reign, the Satavahana Empire declined, leading to the emergence of regional dynasties such as the Ikshvakus, Abhiras and Chutus. Although inscriptions and coins provide different chronological details, APPSC general
26	Who was Satavahana a contemporary of Kharavela? (1) Gautamiputra Satakarni (2) Satakarni-I (3) Hala (4) Pulomavi *APPSC Group-II-B 1989*	**(2) Satakarni-I**	Satakarni-I was a contemporary of the Kalinga king Kharavela. The Hathigumpha inscription describes the battles between them.
27	Which purana gives useful information about Satavahanas? (1) Shiva Purana (2) Matsya Purana (3) Skanda Purana (4) Brahmanda Purana *APPSC Assistant Social Welfare, Assistant BC Welfare & Assis*	**(2) Matsya Purana**	The Matsya Purana gives the Satavahana genealogy, with 30 kings ruling for 450 years.
28	The Satavahana king who has been regarded as kavivatsala was (1) Satakarni II (2) Yagnasri Satakarni (3) Goutamiputra Satakarni (4) Pulomavi *DAO 2011*	**— no key**	
29	Naganika who ruled the South India as a regent during the Satavahana period was the Queen of the following ruler? (1) Srimukha (2) Satakarni I (3) Satakarni II (4) Gowthami Putra Satakarni *APSLPRB Constables Prelims 2023*	**(2) Satakarni I**	
30	Which Satvahana King started the practice of bearing matronym with the original name? (1) Simka (2) Satakarni (3) Vashistiputra Sri Pulumavi (4) Gautamiputra Satakarni *Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20*	**— no key**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
31	The prominent philosopher Acharya Nagarjuna used to be the court of - (1) Yajnashree Satkarni (2) Pulomavi-III (3) Satkarni-I (4) Srimukhudu *Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III (Panchayat Secretary Gr*	**(1) Yajnashree Satkarni**	
32	In the administration of Satavahanas, name the Director of Archives (1) Mahataraka (2) Nibandhanakara (3) Lekhaka (4) Patlika Palaka *APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017*	**— no key**	
33	Who is the founder of Satavahana Dynasty (1) Satakarni-I (2) Kanha (3) Simuka (4) Goutamiputra Satakarni *A.P. Tribal Welfare Officers 2012*	**(3) Simuka**	
34	Who was the founder of Satavahana Empire? (1) Shimukha (2) Krishna (3) Satakarni-1 (4) Purnotsanga *APPSC Sub-Inspectors 2011*	**(1) Shimukha**	
35	According to ancient texts the founder of Satavahana clan? (1) Satakarni-I (2) Kanva (3) Srimukha (4) Gautamiputra Satakarni *APPSC Architecture 2011*	**(3) Srimukha**	
36	The founder of Satavahana Dynasty was (1) Goutami putra Satakarni (2) Satakarni V (3) Kanha (4) Simukha *D.A.O. 2011*	**(4) Simukha**	
37	The first ruler of the Satavahana dynasty (1) Simukha (2) Kanvya (3) Satakarni (4) Pulamavi *APPSC Geologist 2007*	**— no key**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
38	Which Satvahana King started the practice of bearing matronym with the original name? (1) Simuka (2) Satakarni I (3) Vashistiputra Sri Pulumavi (4) Gautamiputra Satakarni *Social and Cultural History of AP and Welfare Programmes 201*	**— no key**	
39	Who was the greatest of the Satavahana kings? (1) Vasishthiputra Pulumavi-II (2) Gautamiputra Satakarni (3) Yajnashri Satakarni (4) Srimukha *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	Gautamiputra Satakarni is regarded as the greatest of all Satavahana kings.
40	The Satavahana ruler who married Rudradaman’s daughter? (1) Srimukha (2) Satakarni (3) Pulomavi (4) Hala *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Satakarni**	Rudradaman’s daughter married Vasishthiputra (Sivasri) Satakarni, as known from the Junagadh/Kanheri records.
41	Who was the founder of the Satavahana dynasty? (1) Sri Satakarni (2) Simukha (3) Pulumavi-I (4) Yajnasri Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Simukha**	Simukha (Srimukha) founded the Satavahana dynasty.
42	Who was the founder of the Satavahana Dynasty? (1) Sri Satakarni (2) Simukha (3) Pulumavi-I (4) Yajna Sri Satakarni *APPSC Group-II 2000 (Optional)*	**(2) Simukha**	Simukha is regarded as the founder of the Satavahana Dynasty, which emerged after the decline of the Mauryan Empire around the 1st century BCE. The Satavahanas became the first major indigenous dynasty to rule the Deccan and laid the foundation for a powerful empire that flourished for nearly four centuries. Hence, the correct answer is Option (2).
43	According to Puranas who was the last ruler of Satavahanas? (1) Sivasri satakarni (2) Vijayasri (3) Chandrasri (4) Pulomavi III *APPSC Group-II 2011*	**(4) Pulomavi III**	The Puranas list Pulomavi III as the 30th and last Satavahana king. Chandasri is the tempting option, but that was an APPSC key based on the Matsya Purana, not the standard Puranic last ruler.
44	King Satavahana who built the town of Navanagara? (1) Simukha (2) Hala (3) Gautamiputrasirisathakarni (4) Pulomawi-II *APPSC Group-II 2000 (Backlog)*	**(4) Pulomawi-II**	Pulomavi-II got the title Navanagara Swami; the Nasik inscription also calls him Dakshinapatheswara.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
45	Who of the following is considered as the founder of the Satavahana rule? (1) Satakarni I (2) Simukha (3) Kuntala Satakarni (4) Gautamiputra Satakarni *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Simukha**	Simuka is regarded as the founder of the Satavahana dynasty.
46	Who among the following is recognized as the founder of the Satavahana administration? (1) Satakarni I (2) Simuka (3) Kuntala Satakarni (4) Gautamiputra Satakarni *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Simuka**	Simuka was the founder of the Satavahana dynasty and is regarded as the architect of the early Satavahana administration. He laid the foundation of the Satavahana Empire around the 1st century BCE, and his successors expanded and consolidated the kingdom. Hence, the correct answer is Option (2). Exam Note: • Founder of Satavahana Dynasty – Simuka
47	A: Coins serve as a crucial archeological source to understand the rule of Satavahanas. R: The coins of Satakarni depict only religious symbols and no portraits of rulers. (1) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A (2) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A (3) A is true, but R is false (4) A is false, but R is true *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) A is true, but R is false**	
48	Which of the following inscription mentioned the Satakarni I as Lord of Dakshinapath? (1) Hathigumpa Inscription (2) Nagarjunakonda Inscription (3) Naganika Inscription (4) Junagarh Inscription *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) Naganika Inscription**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
49	Consider the following statements: A. Gautamiputra Satakarni took pride in calling himself Gautamiputra or the son of Gautami. B. Gautamiputra Satakarni was succeeded by his son Gautamiputra Yagnasri who ruled from 102-130 AD Of the above, the correct statements are (1) Only A (2) A and B (3) Only B (4) Neither A nor B *Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III (Panchayat Secretary Gr*	**(1) Only A**	
50	The Satavahana king who defeated Nahapana was (1) Pulumayi (2) Gautamiputra Satakarni (3) Yajna Satakarni (4) Rudra Satakarni *Group-I 1990-91*	**(2) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	
51	Gowthamiputra Satakarni is described in the following record (1) Nasik Inscription (2) Nanaghat Inscription (3) Kodavali Inscription (4) Hathigumpha Inscription *Assistant Social/BC/Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2*	**(1) Nasik Inscription**	
52	Whom did Gautamiputra Satakarni have to face? (1) Hunas (2) Sakas (3) The Greeks (4) The Parthians *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Sakas**	Gautamiputra Satakarni defeated the Saka (Kshaharata) ruler Nahapana and was called the destroyer of the Sakas.
53	The Satavahanas regained their lost territories from Nahapana during the reign of which king? (1) Simukha (2) Satakarni-II (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Vasishthiputra Pulomavi *APPSC Group-II 2000 (Optional)*	**(3) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	Gautamiputra Satakarni is regarded as the greatest ruler of the Satavahana dynasty. He defeated the Western Kshatrapa ruler Nahapana, recovered territories such as Malwa, Saurashtra, Konkan and Nasik, and restored Satavahana supremacy in the Deccan. The Nasik Inscription of Gautami Balashri records these victories and describes him as the destroyer
54	Which inscription describes the military victories of Gautamiputra Satakarni? (1) Pitalkhora (2) Nashik (3) Nanaghat (4) Junnar *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Nashik**	The Nashik Prasasti, issued by his mother Gautami Balasri in the 19th regnal year of Pulumavi, records Gautamiputra’s victories.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
55	What was the name of the capital of ‘Anupa’, ruled by Gautamiputra Satakarni? (1) Mahishmati (2) Vidisha (3) Ujjain (4) Podana *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Mahishmati**	Anupa was the Narmada valley region, and its capital was Mahishmati; Podana was the capital of Assaka, not Anupa.
56	What was the name of the capital of the place ‘Anupa’ ruled by Gautamiputra Satakarni? (1) Mahishmati (2) Vidisha (3) Ujjain (4) Podna *APPSC Group-II Mains 2017*	**(1) Mahishmati**	According to the Nasik Prasasti of Gautami Balashri, Gautamiputra Satakarni conquered several regions, including Anupa. The capital of Anupa was Mahishmati, situated on the banks of the Narmada River. It was an important political and commercial centre in ancient India and is frequently mentioned in Puranic and historical literature. The conquest o
57	Which inscription describes the military victories of Gautamiputra Satakarni? (1) Pitalpara (2) Nasik (3) Nanaghat (4) Junnar *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Nasik**	The Nasik Inscription of Gautami Balashri gives a detailed account of the military achievements of Gautamiputra Satakarni. It records that he defeated the Sakas, Yavanas and Pahlavas and restored the prestige of the Satavahana dynasty. It is the most important inscription for the political history of the Satavahanas. Hence, the correct answer is Op
58	Name the Capital of a place known as ’ Anupa ’ under Goutami Putra Satakarni? (1) Mahishmati (2) Vidisha (3) Ujjain (4) Podana *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(1) Mahishmati**	Anupa was the Narmada valley region conquered by Gautamiputra, named in the Nasik Prasasti, and its capital was Mahishmati. Vidisha and Ujjain are Malwa centres (Akara and Avanti), not Anupa’s capital.
59	Which of the following inscriptions tells about Gautami putra Satakarni? (1) The Nasik Edict (2) Nanaghat Inscription (3) Kodabali inscription (4) Hathigumpha Inscription *APPSC Assistant Social Welfare, Assistant BC Welfare & Assis*	**(1) The Nasik Edict**	Gautami Balashri inscribed the Nasik inscription during Pulamavi-II’s period, describing the victories of Gautamiputra Satakarni. Nanaghat is Naganika’s, Kodavali is Chanda Siri Satakarni’s and Hathigumpha is Kharavela’s.
60	Who among the following rulers is stated as protector of ‘Varna system’ ? (1) Pushyamitra Sunga (2) Kharvela (3) Gautamiputra Satkarni (4) Vasudev *Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013*	**(3) Gautamiputra Satkarni**	Gautamiputra Satakarni was a patron of Brahmanism. According to Nashik inscription, he did not permit intercaste marriage among the people of the established ‘Four Varnas’ and stopped crossbreeding. That is why he is called the protector of the Varna System.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
61	Where is the inscription describing the achievements of Gautamiputra Satakarni? (1) Ajanta (2) Nashik (3) Amaravati (4) Bhattiprolu *APPSC Group-I 1987*	**(2) Nashik**	Gautami Balashri glorified her son's achievements in the Nasik Prasasti, written in the 19th regnal year of Vasishtiputra Pulomavi.
62	The Nasik inscription mentions whose achievements? (1) Satakarni-II (2) Hala (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Yajnashri Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	The Nasik prashasti of Gautami Balashri describes the achievements of Gautamiputra Satakarni.
63	Which king is described as 'Trisamudradhipati'? (1) Vikramaditya-VI (2) Pulakeshi-II (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Vinayaditya *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	Gautamiputra Satakarni is described in the Nasik inscription as one whose horses drank the waters of the three seas.
64	Which Satavahana emperor got the title 'Dakshinapathapati'? (1) Yagnasri Satakarni (2) Kuntala Satakarni (3) Satakarni-I (4) Hala *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Satakarni-I**	The Naneghat inscription of Naganika calls Satakarni I 'Dakshinapathapati'.
65	The king who bore the title of 'Kavi Vatsala'? (1) Gautamiputra Satakarni (2) Hala Satavahana (3) Madhava Varma-III (4) Rajaraja Narendra *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Hala Satavahana**	Hala, the Satavahana king who compiled the Gathasaptasati, bore the title 'Kavi Vatsala'.
66	Which king bore the title "Kavi Vatsala"? (1) Gautamiputra Satakarni (2) Hala Satavahana (3) Madhava Varma III (4) Rajaraja Narendra *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Hala Satavahana**	King Hala, one of the Satavahana rulers, bore the title "Kavi Vatsala" (Patron of Poets). He is famous for compiling the Gatha Saptasati, a celebrated anthology of about 700 Prakrit verses, dealing mainly with love, nature and rural life. Hence, the correct answer is Option (2). Exam Note: • Kavi Vatsala – Hala Satavahana • Work – Gatha Saptasati
67	The king who bore the title "Kavivatsala" was (1) Gautamiputra Satakarni (2) Hala Satavahana (3) Madhava Varma III (4) Rajaraja Narendra *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Hala Satavahana**	Hala Satavahana bore the title Kavivatsala.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
68	Assertion (A): The Satavahana dynasty came to an end in the mid-3rd century CE. Reason (R): The breakup of the Satavahana empire paved the way for the rise of the Ikshvakus in Andhra. Which one of the following is correct? (1) Both A and R are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A. (2) Both A and R are correct, but R is not the correct explanation of A. (3) A is correct, but R is incorrect. (4) A is incorrect, but R is correct. *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare*	**— no key**	
69	Which Satavahana queen ruled as guardian of the kingdom because her son was young? (1) Lilavati (2) Devi Mathari (3) Gautami Balashri (4) Devi Naganika *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Devi Naganika**	After Satakarni I died young, his queen Naganika ruled as regent for her minor sons (Nanaghat inscription).
70	Maharathi Tranakayiro was the father of which queen? (1) Gautami Balasri (2) Lilavati (3) Rudradamanika (4) Naganika *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Naganika**	Devi Naganika, wife of Satakarni I, was the daughter of Maharathi Tranakayiro.
71	The Satavahana queen, who acted as a regent during the minority of her son, was: (1) Devinaganika (2) Lilavati (3) Gautami Balasri (4) Devi Mathari *APPSC Group-II Mains 2019 Paper-II (19-07-2019)*	**(1) Devinaganika**	Devinaganika (Naganika), queen of the Satavahana dynasty, acted as regent for her minor son after her husband’s death. Her Naneghat inscription is a key source recording Satavahana genealogy.
72	The practice of Satavahana kings prefixing their names with their mother’s name began during whose reign? (1) Gautamiputra Satakarni (2) Simuka (3) Vasishtiputra Pulumavi (4) Hala *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(1) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	The practice of using matronymics (mother’s name) became prominent from the reign of Gautamiputra Satakarni, who styled himself after his mother Gautami Balashri. Later rulers such as Vasishtiputra Pulumavi also continued this tradition. This is considered a distinctive feature of the Satavahana dynasty. Hence, the correct answer is Option (1). Exa

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
73	The practice of Satavahana kings prefixing their personal names with their mothers' names started during whose period? (1) Gautamiputra Satakarni (2) Simukha (3) Vasishtiputra Pulumavi (4) Hala *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	The Satavahana practice of metronymics (prefixing the mother's name) began with Gautamiputra Satakarni.
74	Naganika, who ruled the kingdom as guardian during the Satavahana period, was the queen of which of the following? (1) Srimukha (2) Satakarni-II (3) Satakarni-I (4) Gautamiputra Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Satakarni-I**	Devi Naganika, wife of Satakarni I, ruled as regent for her minor sons and issued the Nanaghat inscription.
75	What do the matronymics preceding the names of the Satavahana kings indicate? (1) Mother's name (2) Name of father's gotra (3) Name of mother's gotra (4) None of these *APPSC Junior Assistants in Labs / Panchayat Raj 2012*	**(1) Mother's name**	The book says matronymics give the mother's name, a practice that began with Gautamiputra Satakarni and reflects polygamy.
76	Which of the following rulers were identified through matronymics (names derived from that of the mother). (1) Mallas of Pava (2) Videhas of Mithila (3) Yaudheyas (4) Satavahanas *CDS 2020*	**(4) Satavahanas**	Among the options, only the Satavahana kings put their mother's name before their own (Gautamiputra, Vasishthiputra, Halamiputra), so they were identified through metronymics.
77	Who was Naganika, the wife of Satakarni-I? (1) The daughter of Maharathi Tranakayira (2) Daughter of Chashtana (3) Daughter of Nahapana (4) Sister of Rudradaman *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) The daughter of Maharathi Tranakayira**	Naganika was the daughter of Maharathi Tranakayira; the marriage allied the Satavahanas with the Maharathis.
78	Who was the earliest Satavahana King to receive wide recognition and called himself 'Dakshinapathapati'? (1) Simukha (2) Sri Satakarni (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Yajnasri Satakarni *Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Ward Education and Data*	**(2) Sri Satakarni**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
79	The Nasik Inscription of Gautami Balasri was engraved during whose reign? (1) Sundara Satakarni (2) Sivasri Satakarni (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Vasishthiputra Pulumavi *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Vasishthiputra Pulumavi**	Gautami Balasri's Nasik prasasti, describing Gautamiputra Satakarni's victories, was engraved in the 19th regnal year of her grandson Vasishthiputra Pulumavi.
80	Who among the following was the Satavahana king who donated a village for the maintenance of Mahasanghika bhikshus at Karle? (1) Satakarni I (2) Pulomavi-II (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Yajnasri Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Gautamiputra Satakarni**	A Karle inscription records Gautamiputra Satakarni's gift of the village Karajaka to the Mahasanghika monks of the Valuraka caves.
81	During whose reign did Gautami Balashri issue the Nasik Inscription? (1) Gautamiputra Satakarni (2) Vasishtiputra Pulumavi (3) Sundara Satakarni (4) Sivashree Satakarni *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Vasishtiputra Pulumavi**	The famous Nasik Prasasti was issued by Gautami Balashri, the mother of Gautamiputra Satakarni, during the reign of her grandson Vasishtiputra Pulumavi. The inscription glorifies Gautamiputra Satakarni as the destroyer of the Sakas, Yavanas and Pahlavas, and is the most important inscription for reconstructing the political history of the Satavahan
82	Identify the inscription of Chanda Satakarni. (1) Kanheri Inscription (2) Kodavali Inscription (3) Amaravati Inscription (4) Karle Inscription *APPSC Group-II Mains 2017*	**(2) Kodavali Inscription**	The Kodavali Inscription is associated with Chanda Satakarni, one of the lesser-known rulers of the Satavahana dynasty. The inscription is an important epigraphic source for reconstructing the genealogy and political history of the later Satavahanas. It also provides valuable information regarding administrative practices and regional authority dur
83	Identity the Inscription of Chanda Satakarni (1) Kanheri Inscription (2) Kodavali Inscription (3) Amaravathi Inscription (4) Karle Inscription *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(2) Kodavali Inscription**	The Kodavali inscription (East Godavari, Pithapuram) is the record of Chanda Satakarni; Kanheri, Amaravati and Karle belong to other rulers.
84	Identify the inscription of Chanda Satakarni? (1) Kanheri Inscription (2) Kodavali inscription (3) Amaravati inscription (4) Carle inscription *APPSC Group-II Mains 2017 Paper-2 (16-07-2017)*	**(2) Kodavali inscription**	Chanda Sri Satakarni issued the inscription at Kodavali village near Pithapuram in East Godavari district.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
85	The capital of the Satavahanas was: (1) Amaravati (2) Kanchi (3) Pratishthana (4) Taxila *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare*	**(3) Pratishthana**	
86	Which was the capital of the Andhra Satavahanas? (1) Dhanyakataka (2) Vengi (3) Warangal (4) Kondapur *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Dhanyakataka**	Satavahana capitals were Kotilingala, Pratishthana and Dhanyakataka; Vengi belonged to the Eastern Chalukyas and Warangal to the Kakatiyas.
87	Which of the following places was the capital of Satvahanas? (1) Pratisthan (2) Nagarjuna Konda (3) Shakal or Sialkot (4) Pataliputra *UP Lower (Pre) 2008*	**(1) Pratisthan**	Pratishthana (Paithan) on the Godavari was the principal Satavahana capital. Nagarjunakonda was an Ikshvaku centre, and Pataliputra was the Magadhan capital.
88	Which one of the prominent cities of Satavahana kingdom in Godavari region? (1) Pratistana (2) Arikamedu (3) Kokkahai (4) Muski *APPSC Assistant Motor Vehicle Inspector 2009 (14-11-2009)*	**(1) Pratistana**	Pratishthana Puram, said to be a capital during the Satavahana period, is located on the banks of the Godavari in Maharashtra. Muski falls under Raichur district of Karnataka, where an Ashoka inscription was found.
89	The capital of the Satavahanas was located at – (1) Amravati (2) Nanded (3) Naldurg (4) Durg *U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005*	**(1) Amravati**	The actual capital of Satavahanas was located at Paithan or Pratisthan, although their initial capital is believed to be Amravati. According to the Puranas, the founder of Satavahana dynasty is believed to be King Simuka.
90	Which was the main town of the Satavahanas? (1) Paithan (2) Amaravati (3) Kondapur (4) Bhattiprolu *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Paithan**	The chief town of the Satavahanas was Paithan (Pratishthana).
91	Where are most of the coins of Seemuka, the progenitor of the Satavahanas, found? (1) Dhulikatta (2) Kotilingala (3) Amaravati (4) Nagarjunakonda *APPSC Assistant Social Welfare, Assistant BC Welfare & Assis*	**(2) Kotilingala**	Simuka, founder of the Satavahana empire, is known from coins found at Kotilingala in Karimnagar district.
92	Who minted Coins with ship symbols? (1) Gauthami Putra Sathakarni (2) Yagnasri Satakarni (3) Pulomavi (4) Srimukha *APPSC Junior Lecturers 2004*	**(2) Yagnasri Satakarni**	Yajnasri Satakarni minted coins with ship symbols, indicating foreign trade.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
93	The ruler who unified a number of principalities into one kingdom and laid the foundation of Satavahana dynasty was (1) Simukha (2) Satakarni II (3) Pulumavi I (4) Pulumavi II *Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20*	**— no key**	
94	Consider the following statements: 1. Satavahana Kingdom was founded by Simuka. 2. Satavahanas claimed Buddhist descent and promoted Buddhist tradition. 3. Satavahanas were involved in prolonged conflict with Shakas over control of premier ports. (1) 1 only (2) 1 and 2 only (3) 1 and 3 only (4) 2 and 3 *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) 1 and 3 only**	

Old PYQs and keys — row 47 (96)

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
1	A: Semi-autonomous feudatories such as Bhojas and Maharathis played a major role in the decentralised nature of Satavahana polity. R: The central Satavahana government discouraged local leadership and directly administered all areas through royal officers. (1) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A (2) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A (3) A is true, but R is false (4) A is false, but R is true *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) A is true, but R is false**	
2	Gadha Saptasati is a Prakrit work compiled by (1) Hala (2) Gunadhya (3) Kuntala Satakarni (4) Pulomavi *Assistant Social/BC/Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2*	**(1) Hala**	
3	Which of the following is wrongly matched? (1) Brihatkatha – Gunadhya (2) Gathasaptashati – Hala (3) Harshacharita – Harshavardhana (4) Mallana – Rajasekhara Charitramu *APPSC Group-I Prelims 2003*	**(3) Harshacharita – Harshavardhana**	Harshacharita was written by Banabhatta, not Harshavardhana. The notes confirm that Brihatkatha is by Gunadhya and the Gathasaptasati is by Hala, so those pairs are right.
4	During the Satavahana period, for the Administrative purpose kingdom was divided as following. (1) Ahara (2) Nadu (3) Sima (4) Sthala *APSLPRB Constables Prelims 2023*	**(1) Ahara**	
5	Satavahana Kingdom was divided into Janapadas, Aaharas and Gramas, who was the head of an Aahara? (1) Amatya (2) Yuvaraja (3) Rajyuka (4) Mahamatra *Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III (Panchayat Secretary Gr*	**(1) Amatya**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
6	Satavahana Kingdom was divided into Janapadas, Aaharas and Gramas, who was the head of an Aahara? (1) Amatya (2) Yuvaraja (3) Rajuka (4) Mahamatra *Grama/Ward Sachivalayam 2019 Category-III Digital Assistant*	**(1) Amatya**	
7	During the time of the Satavahanas, the military bases were under the control of? (1) Amatya (2) Pratiharas (3) Senani (4) Gaulmika *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Gaulmika**	Satavahana military outposts (gulmas) were under the Gaulmika.
8	During Satavahana rule, the administration of what was carried out by the Nigama Sabhas? (1) Villages (2) Cities (3) Territories (4) Religious matters *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Cities**	Nigamas were towns; their corporate affairs were managed by Nigama Sabhas made up of gahapatis.
9	In the Satavahana period, ‘Amatya’ meant? (1) Minister (2) Commander-in-Chief (3) District Officer (4) Village headman (grama pedda) *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Minister**	Amatyas were the ministers who advised the king.
10	What was the largest administrative division during the Satavahana period? (1) Janapada (2) Vishaya (3) Ahara (4) Nadu *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Ahara**	The Satavahanas divided their kingdom into Aharas, each under an Amatya; Soparahara and Govardhanahara were important Aharas.
11	During the rule of the Satavahanas, which administration was carried out by the Nigama Sabhas? (1) Villages (2) Cities (3) Territories (4) Religious matters *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Cities**	The Nigama Sabha was the municipal body during the Satavahana period responsible for the administration of towns and cities. It looked after urban administration, trade, public works, taxation and civic amenities. References to the Nigama Sabha are found in the Nanaghat Inscription, indicating the existence of organized urban self-government. Hence

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
12	During the period of the Satavahanas, the states were divided into ‘Aharas’ under whose control? (1) Mahamatras (2) Kumaramatyas (3) Amatyas (4) Vishayapati *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Amatyas**	Satavahana Aharas were administered by Amatyas.
13	Terms like ‘Kataka’ and ‘Skandhavara’ are commonly used in the Satavahana inscriptions. They are used for which of the following, respectively? (1) Industrial outlets and rural settlements (2) Military camps and settlements (3) Agricultural lands and rural settlements (4) Manufacturing sites and industrial towns *APPSC Junior Assistant in Dr. NTR University of Health Scien*	**(2) Military camps and settlements**	
14	After the decline of which dynasty did the Satavahanas established their independent rule for about 450 years in the Deccan? (1) The Maurayas (2) The Pallavas (3) The Eastern Chalukyas (4) The Ikshvku *Social and Cultural History of AP and Welfare Programmes 201*	**(1) The Maurayas**	
15	In the Satavahana’s inscriptions, the terms ‘Katakas’ and ‘Skandhavaras’ mean: (1) The tax free villages of Buddhist monks (2) Military camps and settlements which served as administrative centres (3) The areas of rock-cut architecture (4) The areas of large scale paddy transplantations *APPSC Group-I Prelims 2024 (17-03-2024)*	**(2) Military camps and settlements which served as administrative centres**	In Satavahana inscriptions, ‘Kataka’ and ‘Skandhavara’ refer to military encampments or fortified settlements, which often developed into administrative centres.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
16	A: The Moturpha was a tax imposed by British on trade and occupations in Andhra. R: Despite levying several taxes British never imposed salt monopoly in the Andhra region. (1) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A (2) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A (3) A is true, but R is false (4) A is false, but R is true *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) A is true, but R is false**	
17	Assertion (A): The Satavahanas performed the ashvamedha sacrifice, similar to other dynasties like the Kshatrapas, as a way to legitimize their power. Reason (R): The Satavahanas extended patronage to both Brahmanas and Buddhist monks, reflecting their diverse approach towards religious and cultural patronage. Which one of the following is correct? (1) Both A and R are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A. (2) Both A and R are correct, but R is not the correct explanation of A. (3) A is correct, but R is incorrect. (4) A is incorrect, but R is correct. *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare*	**(1) Both A and R are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A.**	
18	The exploitation of village servant castes by the feudal lords in Telangana is referred as (1) Jogini (2) Paleru (3) Vetti (4) Biksham *Social Structure, Issues and Public Policies 2016*	**(3) Vetti**	
19	How was the maritime activity of the Satavahanas testified? (1) From the book, Periplus of Erythrean Sea (2) Discovery of a larger number of Roman Coins (3) The figure of a ship found on the coins of Pulomavi and Yagnasri (4) All the given answers are correct *Assistant Social/BC/Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2*	**(4) All the given answers are correct**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
20	Which of these kings were the first in Indian history to make tax free land grants to Buddhists and Brahmanas to gain religious merit? (1) Partian kings (2) Satavahanas kings (3) Kushana kings (4) Shaka kings *APPSC 2023 Screening test (Online Mode) to the post of Deput*	**(2) Satavahanas kings**	The notes state that the Satavahanas made the first tax-free land grants (agraharas) to Brahmanas and Buddhist monks. The Parthians, Kushanas and Shakas are not credited with this.
21	What was the share demanded by the king in the produce of the peasants during the Satavahana period? (1) 1/6th part (2) 1/8th part (3) 1/9th part (4) 1/10th part *APPSC Junior Assistants (Dr. NTR University of Health Scienc*	**(1) 1/6th part**	During the Satavahana period, farmers paid 1/6th of the produce as land tax to the king.
22	During the Satavahana period, the term ‘gandhikas’ was repeatedly mentioned for their generous donations made for Buddhist causes. They belonged to which of the following categories of artisans? (1) Carpenters (2) Masons (3) Goldsmiths (4) Perfumers *APPSC Junior Assistant in Dr. NTR University of Health Scien*	**(4) Perfumers**	
23	Which inscription mentions that Rishabhadatta deposited 2,000 Karshapanas with a guild of weavers of Govardhana? (1) Sopara Inscription (2) Nasik Inscription (3) Kanheri Inscription (4) Pratishthana Inscription *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Nasik Inscription**	The Nasik inscription records that Ushavadatta (Rishabhadatta) deposited 2,000 karshapanas with the weavers’ guild of Govardhana at 12% interest.
24	In the Satavahana period, the guild ‘Padhika’ belongs to? (1) Katikavaru (Butchers) (2) Carpenters (3) Ganugavaru (4) Salevaru (Weavers) *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Carpenters**	Satavahana inscriptions mention 18 guilds; the book identifies Padhika with carpenters.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
25	What was the rate of interest during the Satavahana period on the money deposited in a bank run by Shrenis? (1) 12 (2) 6 (3) 10 (4) 18 *APPSC Group-II 2019*	**(1) 12**	During the Satavahana period, merchant and artisan guilds known as Shrenis functioned not only as professional organizations but also as banking institutions. Individuals deposited money with these guilds, and the deposited amount was utilized for trade and commercial activities. Historical records indicate that the usual rate of interest on such d
26	During the Satavahana period “Kolica Shreni” belongs to whom? (1) Farmers (2) Oil traders (3) Weavers (4) Carpenters *APPSC Group-II 2019*	**(3) Weavers**	During the Satavahana period, occupational guilds known as Shrenis played an important role in economic life. The Kolika (Kolica) Shreni was the guild of weavers. These guilds regulated production, maintained quality standards, organized trade and even functioned as banking institutions by accepting deposits and lending money. The textile industry
27	Which inscription mentions that Rishabhadatta deposited 2,000 Karshapanas in a guild of weavers belonging to Govardhana? (1) Sopara Inscription (2) Nasik Inscription (3) Kanheri Inscription (4) Pratishthana Inscription *APPSC Group-II Mains 2017*	**(2) Nasik Inscription**	The famous Nasik Inscription of Rishabhadatta (Ushavadatta) records that he deposited 2,000 Karshapanas with the guild (Shreni) of weavers at Govardhana. The interest earned from this permanent deposit was utilized for charitable and religious purposes, especially for the maintenance of Buddhist monks. This inscription is one of the strongest piece
28	In the Satavahana period the Guild “Padhika” belonged to? (1) Katikavaru (Butchers) (2) Carpenters (3) Ganugavaru (Oil Pressers) (4) Salevaru (Weavers) *APPSC Group-II 2012*	**(2) Carpenters**	Padhika is a garbled form of Vadhika, the Satavahana-era occupational term for carpenters, so the guild belonged to carpenters.
29	According to Rishabhadatta’s Nasik inscription, what was the rate of interest during the Satavahana period? (1) 6 (2) 9 (3) 12 (4) 18 *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(3) 12**	The Nasik Inscription of Rishabhadatta (Ushavadata) records donations deposited with merchant guilds and indicates that the annual rate of interest was 12%. The inscription is an important source for understanding the banking system, merchant guilds and financial practices during the Satavahana period. Hence, the correct answer is Option (3). Exam

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
30	According to the Nasik inscription of Rishabhadatta, the rate of interest during the Satavahana period was (1) 6 (2) 9 (3) 12 (4) 18 *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(3) 12**	The Nasik inscription records interest at 12% per year (1% per month) in the Satavahana period.
31	Which inscription mentions Ushavadatta investing 2,000 Karshapanas in a weaver's guild at Govardhana (1) Sopara inscription (2) Nasik inscription (3) Kanheri inscription (4) Pratistan inscription *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(2) Nasik inscription**	The Nasik inscription of Ushavadatta (Rishabhadatta) records 2,000 karshapanas deposited with the Govardhana weavers' guild. The Sopara, Kanheri and Pratishthana records are not the source for this.
32	"Chitrameli" was the guild formed by: (1) Painters (2) Agriculturists (3) Dancers (4) Goldsmiths *APPSC Group-II Mains 2019 Paper-II (19-07-2019)*	**(2) Agriculturists**	'Chitrameli' was a guild formed by agriculturists.
33	Generally the rate of interest on the deposits in guilds, during the Satavahana period, was: (1) 6 (2) 10 (3) 12 (4) 18 *APPSC Group-II Mains 2019 Paper-II (19-07-2019)*	**(3) 12**	Inscriptions from the Satavahana period record that guild deposits generally carried an interest rate of about 12%.
34	The 'Kolika' guild of the Satavahana period belongs to: (1) Peasants (2) Oil-mongers (3) Weavers (4) Carpenters *APPSC Group-II Mains 2019 Paper-II (19-07-2019)*	**(3) Weavers**	The 'Kolika' guild mentioned in Satavahana inscriptions refers to weavers.
35	Which one of the following statements is not true about Shreni System of Ancient India? (1) Shreni was the organisation of traders and artisans (2) Quality and the price of the produced goods was (3) Shreni used to control the conduct of its members (4) Shreni system was prevalent only in Northern India *State PSC*	**(4) Shreni system was prevalent only in Northern India**	Shreni system of ancient India was basically the organisation of traders and artisans which used to not just control the quality and prices of the produced goods but also the conduct of its members. This system was prevalent in Northern India as well as southern India. Greek Invasion *In the 6th century BC, there was an ambitious man named Kurush o

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
36	In ancient Andhra, “Kularika” refers to which caste group? (1) Potter (2) Weaver (3) Perfumers (4) Carpentry *APPSC Junior Assistants in Labs / Panchayat Raj 2012*	**(1) Potter**	Kularika, one of the 18 varnas of the Satavahana period, means potter.
37	Which port is not mentioned by historical sources as being in use during the time of the Satavahanas? (1) Kodur (2) Motupalli (3) Kalyan (4) Sopara *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Motupalli**	Kodur, Kalyan and Sopara were Satavahana-era ports; Motupalli rose to prominence under the Kakatiyas.
38	Which town in the Andhra kingdom was described by Ptolemy as a great market? (1) Maisolia (Machilipatnam) (2) Nizampatnam (3) Kalingapatnam (4) Kotilingala *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Maisolia (Machilipatnam)**	Ptolemy’s Geography describes Maisolia (Machilipatnam) as a great trade centre of the Satavahana period.
39	Western port of Satavahana period? (1) Broach (2) Sopara (3) Motupalli (4) None *APPSC Group-II-A 1984*	**(1) Broach**	The book’s answer is 1 & 2: Barygaza (Broach) and Sopara were west coast ports of the Satavahanas. Motupalli is an east coast port.
40	Assertion (A): Trade with Rome flourished in the post-Satavahana era. Reason (R): No ruler had issued coins with ship motif after Satavahanas. (1) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A) (2) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) (3) (A) is true, but (R) is false (4) (A) is false, but (R) is true *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(4) (A) is false, but (R) is true**	Indo-Roman trade actually declined in the post-Satavahana period rather than flourishing, as the Satavahana era (1st Century BCE-3rd century CE) represented the peak of this maritime commerce, evidenced by extensive Roman coin hoards found in Andhra and finds at sites like Kondapur, making Assertion A false. Reason R is factually true-the distincti
41	Which one of the following objects of Roman manufacture has been most abundantly found in India? (1) Pot sherds (2) Bronze icons (3) Lamps (4) Coins *IAS (Pre) 1999*	**(4) Coins**	Roman coins are the most abundant Roman objects found in India, with finds at Bhattiprolu, Nagarjunakonda and other sites, so coins is the correct answer.
42	Which coin was used as currency during the Satavahana period? (1) Sathamana (2) Karshapana (3) Rama Raya (4) Venkataraya *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Karshapana**	Karshapanas, minted in copper and silver, were the currency of the Satavahana period.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
43	Which Andhra dynasty issued iron coins with a thin copper coating? (1) Satavahanas (2) Ikshvakus (3) Salankayanas (4) Vishnukundins *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Satavahanas**	Manchikallu inscription was given by Palla Pallava King Simhavarma invaded Vijayapuri and defeat the Ikshvaka dynasty and destroyed Vijayapuri. Maidavolu Inscription stating that the Pallavas rul which is inscribed by Sivaskanda Varma.,
44	Which Dynasty of Andhra issued iron coins with a thin coating of copper? Q6 for (1) Satavahanas (2) Ikshvakus (3) Salankayanas (4) Vishnukundins *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(2) Ikshvakus**	The Ikshvaku dynasty, which ruled the Krishna-Guntur region after the Satavahanas, is known to have issued a distinctive type of coinage consisting of iron coins with a thin copper coating, unlike the more common lead / copper coins of the Satavahanas.
45	The following symbol is mostly found on the coins of the Satavahanas (1) Goddess Lakshmi (2) Garuda (3) Ship (4) The arrow *APPSC Assistant Social Welfare, Assistant BC Welfare & Assis*	**(3) Ship**	Most Satavahana coins carry a ship symbol indicating foreign trade; three-masted ship coins of Yajna Sri Satakarni were found at Chebrolu, Guntur district.
46	Which of the following metals was NOT used by satavahanas in issuing coins? (1) Nickel (2) Lead (3) Copper (4) Silver *APPSC 2022 Assistant Conservator of Forest*	**(1) Nickel**	Satavahana coins were of lead, copper, bronze, silver and potin; nickel was not used, so nickel is the metal that was not used.
47	From the following evidence we know that the Satavahanas were engaged in naval trade? (1) Matsyapurana (2) Lilavati (3) Pulomayi, Yajnashri hallmarked ship symbol coins (4) Hala’s Gathasaptasati *APPSC Group-II-A 1989*	**(3) Pulomayi, Yajnashri hallmarked ship symbol coins**	Ship-marked coins minted by Pulomavi-I and Yajnashri Satakarni show the development of sea trade. Trade with Rome took place on a large scale during this period.
48	The official language of the Satavahanas was (1) Sanskrit (2) Prakrit (3) Pali (4) Aramic *APPSC General Studies & Mental Ability (Common Paper for Var*	**(2) Prakrit**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
49	The donation of land to religious and educational institutions was a common practice in ancient India. In this context, which of the following kingdoms was the first to donate land to the Brahmana social class? (1) Ikshvaku (2) Satavahana (3) Gupta (4) Maurya *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(2) Satavahana**	
50	After the decline of which dynasty did the Satavahanas established their independent rule for about 450 years in the Deccan? (1) The Mauryas (2) The Pallavas (3) The Eastern Chalukyas (4) The Ikshvakus *Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20*	**— no key**	
51	Under the Satvahana dynasty, which one of the following were not the feudal chiefs? (1) Maharathas (2) Mahasenapatis (3) Mahabhojas (4) Mahajanpadas *Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20*	**(4) Mahajanpadas**	
52	Which is the official language of Satavahanas? (1) Telugu (2) Marathi (3) Prakrit (4) Vaishnava *APPSC Port Officer 2011*	**(3) Prakrit**	
53	The language that is noticed in the early inscriptions of the Ikshvakus is (1) Sanskrit (2) Pali (3) Prakrit (4) Brahmi *Gazetted 2006*	**(3) Prakrit**	
54	What was the royal language of the Satavahanas? (1) Telugu (2) Sanskrit (3) Prakrit (4) Tamil *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Prakrit**	Both the official language and the inscriptions of the Satavahanas were in Prakrit; Hala wrote the Gathasaptasati in Prakrit.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
55	Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R). Assertion (A) : In Satavahana period, Sanskrit along with Prakrit and other folk languages were developed. Reason (R) : Satavahana Kings promoted the use of Sanskrit and other folk languages for literary writings. Choose the correct answer using the codes given. (1) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is correct (2) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is not the correct (3) (A) is true, but (R) is false (4) (A) is false, but (R) is true *U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017*	**(1) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is correct**	In the Satavahana period, Sanskrit along with Prakrit and other folk languages were developed. Satavahana king promoted the use of Sanskrit and other folk languages for literary writings.
56	In which language were the inscriptions of the Satavahanas issued? (1) Sanskrit (2) Tamil (3) Prakrit (4) Telugu *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Prakrit**	Satavahana inscriptions are in Prakrit.
57	Which language was used in the inscription of Satavahanas? (1) Telugu (2) Sanskrit (3) Prakrit (4) Tamil *APPSC Group-II 2011*	**(3) Prakrit**	The official and inscriptional language of the Satavahanas was Prakrit written in Brahmi script, not Telugu, Sanskrit or Tamil.
58	What is the Importance of Amaravati (1) Arts of Bharedhar (2) Arts of Madhusa (3) Satavahana arts (4) Temples of Kakatiyas *APPSC Port Officer 2011*	**(3) Satavahana arts**	
59	Which of the following is not correct regarding the socio-economic and religious conditions of the Satavahanas? (1) Although the Satavahana kings followed Hinduism, some of their queens patronized Buddhism. (2) Chaturvarna system existed. (3) Women were looked down upon. (4) The shipping industry developed. *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(3) Women were looked down upon.**	The statement is incorrect because women enjoyed a respectable position in Satavahana society. Evidence includes: • Queens such as Gautami Balashri and Naganika issued inscriptions and made religious donations. • Satavahana rulers commonly used matronymics, identifying themselves by their mothers' names (e.g., Gautamiputra Satakarni). The remaining

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
60	Which of the following is correct regarding the Satavahana period? (1) The family is patriarchal (2) Monarchy, like the family, is matriarchal (3) The family is matriarchal, but the kingdom is patriarchal (4) Family and monarchy are both patriarchal *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Family and monarchy are both patriarchal**	Satavahana society was patriarchal and kingship passed from father to son, though women held a respectable position.
61	Which of the following is correct with regard to satavahana period? (1) Family was Patriarchal (2) Family was matriarchal (3) Family was matriarchal, but kingship was patriarchal (4) Both family and kingship who patriarchal *APPSC Group-II 2011*	**(4) Both family and kingship who patriarchal**	Kingship was hereditary and patriarchal, and society remained patriarchal even though women were respected, so both family and kingship were patriarchal.
62	The Katantara grammar was written by? (1) Gunadhya (2) Nagarjuna (3) Sarvavarma (4) Sudraka *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) Sarvavarma**	
63	Which language was predominantly used in Satavahana inscriptions? (1) Sanskrit (2) Tamil (3) Maharashtri Prakrit (4) Pali *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare*	**(3) Maharashtri Prakrit**	
64	____ was authored by Gunadhya, the minister under the ruler of Hala. (1) Brihatkatha (2) Milindapano (3) Buddhacharita (4) Svapanavasavadatta *Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20*	**— no key**	
65	Who is the author of 'Brihatkatha'? (1) Gunadhya (2) Abburi Chayadevi (3) Satyam Sankararaman (4) Umar Alisha *Polytechnic Lecturers (S2) 2020*	**— no key**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
66	____ was authored by Gunadhya, the minister under the ruler of Hala (1) Brihatkatha (2) Milindapanho (3) Buddhacharita (4) Svapnavasavadatta *Social and Cultural History of AP and Welfare Programmes 201*	**— no key**	
67	The following literary work is not written by Kalidasa (1) Meghasandesam (2) Raghuvamsam (3) Vikramorvasiyam (4) Naganandam *SI Paper-II Preliminary Exam 2016*	**(4) Naganandam**	
68	The Sanskrit grammar book Katantra Vyakaranam was authored by? (1) Hala (2) Gunadhya (3) Patanjali (4) Sharva Varma *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Sharva Varma**	Sarvavarma, in the court of the Satavahanas, wrote the Sanskrit grammar Katantra Vyakaranam.
69	The Jain philosophical treatise 'Samayasara' was authored by? (1) Somadevasuri (2) Mahaviracharya (3) Pujyapadacharya (4) Kundakundacharya *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Kundakundacharya**	Samayasara was written by Kundakundacharya.
70	Gathasaptasati was written by? (1) Sarvavarma (2) Gunadhya (3) Hala (4) Kuntala Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Hala**	Hala compiled the Gathasaptasati in Maharashtri Prakrit.
71	Who is the author of the Gatha Saptasati? (1) Shudraka (2) Sharvavarma (3) Gunadhya (4) Hala *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Hala**	Hala wrote Gatha Saptasati; Shudraka wrote Mricchakatika, Sharvavarma Katantra Vyakarana and Gunadhya Brihatkatha.
72	Gathasaptasati was written by? (1) Sharva Varma (2) Gunadhya (3) Hala (4) Kuntala Satakarni *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(3) Hala**	King Hala, a Satavahana ruler, compiled the famous Gathasaptasati, an anthology of nearly 700 Prakrit verses dealing mainly with love, village life and nature. It is one of the earliest and most important works in Prakrit literature. Hence, the correct answer is Option (3). Exam Note: • Gathasaptasati → Hala

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
73	The author of Gathasaptasati was (1) Sarva Varma (2) Gunadya (3) Hala (4) Kuntala Satakarni *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(3) Hala**	The Gathasaptasati (Gaha Sattasai) is attributed to the Satavahana king Hala.
74	The author of Gathasaptasati was (1) Sarva Varma (2) Gunadya (3) Hala (4) Kuntala Satakarni *APPSC Group-II (old paper)*	**(3) Hala**	The Gathasaptasati (Gaha Sattasai) is attributed to the Satavahana king Hala.
75	Statement (A): ” Gatha Saptasathi ” is a collection of poems which predominantly focused on love and romantic themes. Statement (B): Gunadya had written Brihatkatha in Sanskrit language. (1) Both (A) and (B) are true (2) Both (A) and (B) are false (3) (A) is true, but (B) is false (4) (A) is false, but (B) is true *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(3) (A) is true, but (B) is false**	‘Gatha Saptasati’, compiled by the Satavahana king Hala, is indeed a celebrated Prakrit anthology on love, romance and rural life, so Statement A is true. However, Gunadhya’s ’ Brihatkatha ’ was composed in Paishachi Prakrit, not Sanskrit, making Statement B false. Paishachi was a distinct dialect, and the lost original was later adapted into Sans
76	The Jain Philosophical work “Samayasara” was composed by: (1) Mahaviracharya (2) Pujyapadacharya (3) Kondakundacharya (4) Somadeva Suri *APPSC Group-II Mains 2019 Paper-II (19-07-2019)*	**(3) Kondakundacharya**	The Jain philosophical work ‘Samayasara’ was composed by Acharya Kundakunda (Kondakundacharya), one of the most revered teachers of Digambara Jainism.
77	Who is the author of Gadha Saptasati Granth? (1) Shudraka (2) Sharvavarma (3) Gunadya (4) Hala *APPSC Group-II-A 1991*	**(4) Hala**	Hala wrote Gathasaptasati; Shudraka wrote Mricchakatika, Sharvavarma Katantra Vyakaranam and Gunadya Brihatkatha.
78	Match the following mentioned texts with their authors? a. Prajnaparamita b. Samaya Sara c. Lilavati parinayam d. Katantra vyakaranam I. Konda Kundacharya II. Sarvavarma III. Acharya Nagarjuna IV. Kuthuhala Select the correct answer using the codes given below? (1) a-III, b-I, c-II, d-IV (2) a-I, b-III, c-IV, d-II (3) a-III, b-I, c-IV, d-II (4) a-I, b-II, c-III, d-IV *APPSC Group-I 2023 (08-01-2023)*	**(3) a-III, b-I, c-IV, d-II**	Prajnaparamita - Acharya Nagarjuna, Samayasara - Konda Kundacharya, Lilavati Parinayam - Kutuhala, Katantra Vyakarana - Sarvavarma.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
79	Who wrote ‘Katantra Vyakaranam’? (1) Patanjali (2) Gunadayu (3) Agastya (4) Sarva Varma *APPSC Group-I Re-exam 2010*	**(4) Sarva Varma**	At the request of Kuntala Satakarni, Sharvavarma wrote the Katantra Vyakaranam so that everyone could learn Sanskrit easily.
80	Katantravyakarana was composed by: (1) Patanjali (2) Agastya (3) Gunadhya (4) Sarvavarma *APPSC Group-1 PYQ*	**(4) Sarvavarma**	The Katantra Vyakarana, a simplified Sanskrit grammar, was composed by Sarvavarma.
81	Who compiled the Prakrit text Gadha Saptashati? (1) Hala (2) Gunadyadu (3) Kuntala Satakarni (4) Pulomawi *APPSC Assistant Social Welfare, Assistant BC Welfare & Assis*	**(1) Hala**	Hala, known as Kavi Vatsala, wrote Gathasaptasati in Prakrit. Gunadhya wrote Brihatkatha in Paisachi.
82	Which of the following texts contains contributions by women? (1) Brihat Katha (2) Kamasutra (3) Gathasaptasati (4) Lilavati *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Gathasaptasati**	Hala’s Gathasaptasati includes verses written by women poets.
83	Who is the author of the Gatha Saptasati? (1) Shudraka (2) Sarvavarma (3) Gunadhya (4) Hala *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Hala**	The 17th Satavahana king Hala compiled the Gatha Saptasati in Prakrit.
84	Gatha Saptasati was written by? (1) Rudramadevi (2) Hala (3) Lilavati (4) Yajnashri Satakarni *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Hala**	Hala wrote Gatha Saptasati in Prakrit, seven hundred verses on rural life and love.
85	Which of the following texts contained writing by the women (1) Brihatkatha (2) Kamasutra (3) Gatha Saptasati (4) Lilavati *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(3) Gatha Saptasati**	The Gathasaptasati contains verses by women contributors such as Anulakshmi, Anupalabdha, Reva and Madhavi. Brihatkatha, Kamasutra and Lilavati are not noted for women’s contributions.
86	Which book was written by Hala? (1) Kalyana Manjari (2) Shadi (3) Gatha Saptasati (4) Manjira nadas *APPSC Group-II-B 1989*	**(3) Gatha Saptasati**	Hala wrote Gathasaptasati in Prakrit.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
87	Gathasaptasati was written by? (1) Rudramadeva (2) Hala (3) Lilavati (4) Yagnashree Satakarni *APPSC Group-II-A 1984*	**(2) Hala**	Hala wrote Gathasaptasati in Prakrit, containing seven hundred verses.
88	Match the following books with their authors : List I a. Prajnaparamita b. Samayasara c. Lilavati Parinayam d. Katantra Vyakaranam List II I. Acharya Kundakunda II. Sarvavarma III. Acharya Nagarjuna IV. Kuthuhala (1) a-I, b-II, c-III, d-IV (2) a-II, b-I, c-IV, d-III (3) a-III, b-I, c-IV, d-II (4) a-IV, b-III, c-II, d-I *APPSC Group-I 2023 (08-01-2023)*	**(3) a-III, b-I, c-IV, d-II**	Prajnaparamita is by Nagarjuna, Samayasara by Kundakundacharya, Lilavati Parinayam by Kutuhala and Katantra Vyakaranam by Sarvavarma, which gives a-III, b-I, c-IV, d-II.
89	The history of the early Satavahanas is not mentioned in which book? (1) Pratishthanapura Kalpa (2) Dwatrimsat Puttalika (3) Kathasaritsagaram (4) Gathasaptasati *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Gathasaptasati**	Gathasaptasati is a collection of 700 rural romantic verses, unlike the other texts which narrate Satavahana origins.
90	Which of the following ports were located on the eastern coast during the Satavahana era? 1. Barygaza 2. Gantasala 3. Koddur 4. Masulipatnam 5. Kalyan (1) 2 and 4 (2) 1 and 5 (3) 1 and 2 (4) 3 and 5 *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(1) 2 and 4**	
91	Which professions belonged to the third social class during the Satavahana rule? 1. Suvarnakera 2. Halakiya 3. Lekhaka 4. Maharathis 5. Gandhika (1) 1 and 3 (2) 2 and 4 (3) 1 and 5 (4) 3 and 4 *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) 1 and 5**	
92	The incharge of the royal treasure under the Satavahanas was (1) Mahataraka (2) Pratihari (3) Dhutaka (4) Heranika *APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017*	**— no key**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
93	The village headman during the Satavahana period was called? (1) Gramika (2) Nibandhanakara (3) Mahamatya (4) Amatya *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Gramika**	The village headman of the Satavahana period was called Gramika.
94	Who was the treasurer of the kingdom during the time of Satavahanas? (1) Mahataraka (2) Pratihara (3) Dhutaka (4) Heranica *APPSC Assistant Social Welfare, Assistant BC Welfare & Assis*	**(4) Heranica**	Heranika was the treasurer, Pratihara the protector of the fort and Mahataraka the protector of the village.
95	With reference to the Satavahana Rulers which of the following statement/s is/are true? 1. The Satavahana Kings were the nurturers of Prakrit language. 2. Public aspect of the arts got more encouragement during the Satavahana period. Select the correct answer using the codes given below. Codes (1) Only 1 (2) Both 1 and 2 (3) Only 2 (4) Neither 1 nor 2 *U.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021*	**(2) Both 1 and 2**	Satavahana rulers patronised Prakrit more than Sanskrit. Political inscriptions also shed some light on the rare use of Sanskrit Literature. Also, public aspect of the arts got more encouragement during Satavahana period. Examples of architecture and sculptures found from the Satavahana era are associated with Buddhism.
96	Which of the following are wrongly paired? (1) Brhatkatha - Gunadhya (2) Gathasaptasati - Hala (3) Harshacharitha - Harshavardhanudu (4) Mallana - Rajasekhara Charita *Group-I 2003*	**(3) Harshacharitha - Harshavardhanudu**	

Old PYQs and keys — row 48 (41)

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
1	Who of the following is NOT the winner of Pulitzer awards in 2022? (1) James Ijames (2) Nicole Eustace (3) Diane Seuss (4) Katori Hall *APPSC Assistant Conservator of Forests General Studies & Men*	**(4) Katori Hall**	
2	Which dynasty built stupas, viharas, and temples at Nagarjunakonda, showing support for both Vedic and Buddhist traditions? (1) Mauryas (2) Satavahanas (3) Ikshvakus (4) Pallavas *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare*	**(3) Ikshvakus**	
3	Identify the places where Buddhism was popularised in Andhra Pradesh (1) Amaravathi (2) Battiprolu (3) Guntupalli (4) All the above *AEE 2011*	**(4) All the above**	
4	The prayer halls built by Buddhists are called? (1) Chaitya Shalas or Chaitya Grihas (2) Viharas (3) Caves (4) Arches *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Chaitya Shalas or Chaitya Grihas**	Buddhist prayer halls are called Chaityas; residential monasteries are called Viharas.
5	Match List-A with List-B and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: List-A 1-Stupa 2-Garbhagrtha 3-Mandapa List-B (a) Place where the image of the deity is installed (b) Mound (c) Circular path around the stupa 4-Pradakshina patha (d) Place in temples where people could assemble (1) 1-(b),2-(a),3-(d),4-(c) (2) 1-(c),2-(a),3-(d),4-(b) (3) 1-(b),2-(a),3-(c),4-(d) (4) 1-(a),2-(b),3-(d),4-(c) *APPSC*	**(1) 1-(b),2-(a),3-(d),4-(c)**	Stupa is a mound, the garbhagriha is where the deity's image is installed, and the pradakshina patha is the circular path around the stupa. The mandapa is the assembly place in temples, which gives 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
6	Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched? (1) Vikramsila Monastery – Uttar Pradesh (2) Hemkund Gurudwara – Himachal Pradesh (3) Udayagiri Caves – Maharashtra (4) Amaravati Buddhist Stupa – Andhra Pradesh *UPSC CSE Prelims 2006*	**(4) Amaravati Buddhist Stupa – Andhra Pradesh**	The Amaravati Buddhist Stupa is located in Andhra Pradesh. Vikramsila Monastery was in Bihar, Hemkund Sahib is in Uttarakhand, and the Udayagiri Caves are located in Odisha and Madhya Pradesh.
7	Some Buddhist rock-cut caves are called Chaityas, while the others are called Viharas. What is the difference between the two? (1) Vihara is a place of worship, while Chaitya is the dwelling place of the monks (2) Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of the monks (3) Chaitya is the stupa at the far end of the cave, while Vihara is the hall axial to it (4) There is no material difference between the two *UPSC CSE Prelims 2013*	**(2) Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of the monks**	‘Vihara’ is a Sanskrit and Pali term referring to a Buddhist monastery. Literally meaning “a place for walking or wandering,” it originally denoted temporary shelters used by itinerant monks, especially during the rainy season. A ‘Chaitya’ refers to a Buddhist shrine or prayer hall that contains a stupa at one end. In modern studies of Indian archi
8	With reference to ancient India, consider the following statements: 1. The concept of Stupa is Buddhist in origin. 2. Stupa was generally a repository of relics. 3. Stupa was a votive and commemorative structure in Buddhist tradition. How many of the statements given above are correct? (1) Only one (2) Only two (3) All three (4) None *UPSC CSE Prelims 2023*	**(2) Only two**	Statement 1 is incorrect: A stupa is a mound-like structure that enshrines relics of the Buddha or Buddhist monks and is venerated in Buddhism, though the tradition itself predates Buddhism. In Vedic society, funerary practices such as pitramedha involved collecting ashes or bodily remains in an urn and constructing a memorial mound over it. Refere
9	In Indian art, the construction of ‘Stupa’, ‘Chaitya’ and ‘Vihara’ is related to which of the following? (1) Ajivika sect (2) Vaishnava sect (3) Buddhism (4) Shaiva sect *State PSC*	**(3) Buddhism**	‘Stupa’, ‘Chaitya’ and ‘Vihara’ all are related to Buddhism. Stupa is a dirt burial mound faced with stone. In Buddhism, the earliest stupas contained portions of the Buddha’s ashes, and as a result, it began to be associated with the body of the Buddha. Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of monks.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
10	Some Buddhist rock-cut caves are called Chaityas, while the others are called Viharas. What is the difference between the two? (1) Vihara is a place of worship, while Chaitya is the (2) Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the (3) Chaitya is the stupa at the far end of the cave, while (4) There is no material difference between the two *I.A.S. (Pre) 2013*	**(2) Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the**	A chaitya is a prayer and assembly hall, often with a stupa at the far end, while a vihara is a monastery where monks live. So option 2 is right; option 1 reverses the two.
11	Consider the following statements, what is the difference between Chaityas and Viharas? (1) Viharas are places of worship while Chaitya is (2) Chaitya is a place of worship while Vihara is a (3) There is no particular difference between both of them (4) Viharas and Chaityas both are used as dwelling place *U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001*	**(2) Chaitya is a place of worship while Vihara is a**	A Chaitya-Griha Buddhist cave is a meeting or assembly chamber which is often used for prayer, while Viharas are the shelter accommodations of the monks during the rainy season.
12	In which of the following stupas, the features of a platform with 'Aryak-Pillars' are found ? (1) Ghantshal (2) Bodhgaya (3) Nagarjunikonda (4) Amaravati *U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022*	**(4) Amaravati**	Amravati Stupa has Features of a platform with Aryak-pillars (Ayaka pillars). It is situated in Andhra Pradesh.
13	Who of the following enlarged the famous 'Amaravati Stupa' and constructed the famous railing round the 'Mahachaitya'? (1) Simukha (2) Gautamiputra Yagnasri (3) Acharya Nagarjuna (4) Vasistiputra Pulomavi *Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Animal Husbandry Assist*	**(2) Gautamiputra Yagnasri**	
14	Who of the following Satavahana kings enlarged the Amaravathi Stupa and constructed a stone railing around the Mahachaitya? (1) Vasistiputra Satakarni (2) Yajnasri Satakarni (3) Goutamiputra Satakarni (4) Srimukha *Group-II (year not legible)*	**(2) Yajnasri Satakarni**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
15	Who of the following enlarged the ‘Amaravati Stupa’ and constructed the famous railing round the ‘Mahachaitya’ ? (1) Simukha (2) Gautamiputra Yagnasri (3) Acharya Nagarjuna (4) Vasishtiputra Pulomavi *AP Grama Ward Sachivalayam Category-III Animal Husbandry Ass*	**(2) Gautamiputra Yagnasri**	
16	Who was the Satavahana emperor who enlarged the Amaravati stupa and built a stone railing around the Mahachaitya? (1) Vasishtiputra Satakarni (2) Yajnasri Satakarni (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Srimukha *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Vasishtiputra Satakarni**	The Amaravati Mahachaitya was enlarged and given its stone railing in the time of the later Satavahana ruler Vasishthiputra (Pulumavi/Satakarni), not the early king Srimukha.
17	Who was the Satavahana emperor who enlarged the Amaravati Stupa and constructed the stone railing around the Mahachaitya? (1) Vasishthiputra Satakarni (2) Yajna Sri Satakarni (3) Gautamiputra Satakarni (4) Srimukha *APPSC Group-II 2001*	**(1) Vasishthiputra Satakarni**	The Amaravati Mahachaitya was originally constructed during the early Satavahana period and was greatly enlarged during the reign of Vasishthiputra Satakarni. During his reign: • The stupa was expanded. • Beautiful limestone sculptures were added. • A magnificent stone railing (Vedika) was constructed around the Mahachaitya. Amaravati subsequently
18	The Amaravati stupa was built during whose reign? (1) Vengi Chalukyas (2) Ikshvakus (3) Satavahanas (4) Salankayanas *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Satavahanas**	The Amaravati Mahastupa was built and enlarged mainly under the Satavahanas.
19	Which of the below mentioned Boudha Stupas in South is larger and more artistic than those located in North India at Saanchi or Barhut? (1) Amaravathi (2) Bhattiprolu (3) Ghantasaala (4) Nagarjunakonda *APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017*	**(1) Amaravathi**	
20	At Amaravati, Jaggayyapeta and Nagarjunakonda, stupas and viharas were built over whose remains? (1) Nagarjuna (2) Mahavira (3) Gautama Buddha (4) Gomateshwara *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Gautama Buddha**	These are Dhatugarbha stupas, built over the bodily relics of the Buddha.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
21	The stupas and viharas at Amaravati, Jaggayyapeta and Nagarjunakonda were built over whose relics? (1) Nagarjuna (2) Mahavira (3) Gautama Buddha (4) Gomateshwara *APPSC Group-II 2002*	**(3) Gautama Buddha**	The famous Buddhist monuments at Amaravati, Jaggayyapeta and Nagarjunakonda are relic stupas, constructed to enshrine the sacred relics of Gautama Buddha. These centres flourished under the patronage of the Satavahanas and later the Ikshvakus. Excavations have revealed relic caskets, Buddhist sculptures, inscriptions, monasteries (Viharas), Chaitya
22	Assertion (A): Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda emerged as prominent stupa-monastery complexes in ancient Andhra. Reason (R): Both sites were strategically located near urban centres and along important trade and pilgrimage routes, facilitating Buddhist patronage and growth. Which one of the following is correct? (1) Both A and R are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A. (2) Both A and R are correct, but R is not the correct explanation of A. (3) A is correct, but R is incorrect. (4) A is incorrect, but R is correct. *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer (A.P. Tribal Welfare*	**(1) Both A and R are correct, and R is the correct explanation of A.**	
23	Where was the largest Buddhist stupa of South India constructed? (1) Bhattiprolu (2) Amaravathi (3) Bojjannakonda (4) Salihundam *APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017*	**— no key**	
24	According to the Bhattiprolu inscription, who was the ruler in the 3rd century BC? (1) Sudarshana (2) Mahadeva (3) Kubiraka (4) Ashoka *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Kubiraka**	The Bhattiprolu casket inscriptions name Raja Kubiraka.
25	Where is the famous bulging rock stone showing the raised hand of Emperor Mandhata? (1) Simhachalam (2) Kondapuram (3) Jaggayyapet (4) Bastari *APPSC Group-I 1991*	**(3) Jaggayyapet**	The Mandhata sculpture is prominent among the sculptures of the Ikshvaku period.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
26	Indian archaeologists recently unearthed a rare life-sized stucco sculpture from a Buddhist site in (1) Andhra Pradesh (2) Odisha (3) Telangana (4) Madhya Pradesh *APPSC Group-1 PYQ*	**(3) Telangana**	The Phanigiri Buddhist site in Suryapet, Telangana, yielded a life-size stucco sculpture, so the answer is Telangana.
27	Identify the wrong pair among the following. (1) Guntupalli - Siddharthaka Chaitya (2) Purvasailam - Dhanyakataka (3) Aparasailam - Sriparvatam (4) Uttarasailam - Jaggayyapeta *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Guntupalli - Siddharthaka Chaitya**	Guntupalli was the centre of the Rajagirika school; the Siddharthika school was at Gudivada.
28	The Chaitya referred to as Siddharthaka Chaitya in Buddhist literature was identified as being at? (1) Guntupalli (2) Gudivada (3) Jaggayyapeta (4) Bhattiprolu *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Gudivada**	Among the Chaityaka branches: Purvasaila - Dhanyakataka, Uttarasaila - Jaggayyapeta, Rajagirika - Guntupalli, Siddharthika - Gudivada.
29	The Chaitya referred to as Siddharthaka Chaitya in Buddhist literature has been identified with which place? (1) Guntupalli (2) Gudivada (3) Jaggayyapeta (4) Bhattiprolu *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Gudivada**	The Siddharthaka Chaitya of Buddhist literature is identified with Gudivada; Guntupalli was the centre of the Rajagirika school.
30	Find out the wrong match: (1) Guntupalli-Siddharthaka chaitya (2) Purvasaila - Dhanyakataka (3) Aparasaila - Sriparvata (4) Uttarasaila - Jaggayyapeta *APPSC Group-II 2011*	**(1) Guntupalli-Siddharthaka chaitya**	Guntupalli is the centre of the Rajagirika sect, while the Siddharthaka chaitya is at Gudivada. So pairing Guntupalli with Siddharthaka chaitya is the wrong match; the other three sect–centre pairs are correct.
31	The word ‘Tambaya danam’ is noticed in the Buddhist site at the following place (1) Chandavaram (2) Amaravati (3) Bhattiprolu (4) Kotturu *Police Constable Preliminary 2019*	**(4) Kotturu**	
32	In which district is the term ‘Tambaya Danamu’ found in a Buddhist settlement? (1) Kurnool (2) Krishna (3) Visakhapatnam (4) West Godavari *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Visakhapatnam**	The term is found at a Buddhist settlement on the Sarada river near Yelamanchili in Visakhapatnam district.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
33	In which of the following Buddhist settlements is the term ‘Tambaya Dana’ identified? (1) Chandravaram (2) Amaravati (3) Bhattiprolu (4) Kotturu *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Kotturu**	The term ‘Tambaya Dana’ is found at Kotturu (Dhanadibbalu), a Buddhist site on the Sarada river in Visakhapatnam district.
34	In which district is the term ‘Tambaya Danamu’ found in the Buddhist settlement? (1) Kurnool (2) Krishna (3) Visakhapatnam (4) West Godavari *APPSC Group-II Mains 2017*	**(3) Visakhapatnam**	Tambaya danam is noticed at the Buddhist site Kotturu in Visakhapatnam district.
35	The largest and the most evolved rock-cut Chaitya hall of the Hinayana phase is situated at : (1) Pitalkhora (2) Junnar (3) Karle (4) Bedsa *U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014*	**(3) Karle**	The Chaitya is the largest and most evolved cave temple of the Hinayana phase of Buddhism, situated at Karle in the Pune district of Maharashtra.
36	Consider the following statements. I. The early Chaityagrihas and Viharas of Guntupalli in West Godavari district are rock cut. II. The Chaityas and Viharas of Eastern deccan are usually rock cut. Of these statements. (1) Only I is correct (2) Only II is correct (3) Both I and II are correct (4) Neither I nor II is correct *UPPSC 2017*	**(1) Only I is correct**	Guntupalli has rock-cut chaityas and viharas, so I is correct. Eastern Deccan chaityas and viharas are usually structural, with Guntupalli the rock-cut exception, so II is wrong.
37	Consider the following statements. I. The Buddhists in Deccan excavated rock-cut Chaityas and the Vaishnavas, Shaivas and Jainas imitated these in later centuries. II. The Vaishnavas, Shaivas and Jainas excavated temples at sites far distant from rock-cut Chaityas. Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct? (1) Only I (2) Only II (3) Both I and II (4) Neither I nor II *NDA 2011*	**(1) Only I**	The notes do not say which religious groups imitated the Buddhist rock-cut chaityas later, or where their temples stood, so no line settles this. Statement I (the Buddhists excavated first and others imitated them later) is the one accepted as correct.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
38	Consider the following statements: 1. The early Chaityagrihas and Viharas of Guntuphalli in West Godavari district are rock cut. 2. The Chaityas and Viharas of Eastern Deccan are usually rock cut. Of these statements: (1) Only 1 is correct (2) Only 2 is correct (3) Both 1 and 2 are correct (4) Neither 1 nor 2 is correct *U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017*	**(3) Both 1 and 2 are correct**	When the question was asked Guntuphalli was in the West Godavari district of Andhra Pradesh (Now it is in the NTR district). It has rock-cut Chaityas and Viharas. Chaityas and Viharas of Eastern Deccan are usually rock cut.
39	Which of the following Stupas is the biggest in Andhra Pradesh? (1) Jaggayyapeta (2) Amaravati (3) Bhattiprolu (4) Nagarjunakonda *APPSC Group-II Prelims 2019*	**(2) Amaravati**	The Amaravati Stupa, also known as the Mahachaitya, is the largest Buddhist Stupa in Andhra Pradesh and one of the most magnificent Buddhist monuments in India. Originally constructed during the Satavahana period and enlarged under the Ikshvakus, the stupa became an important centre of Mahayana Buddhism. It was renowned for its exquisitely carved l
40	Which of the following stupas in Andhra Pradesh is the biggest? (1) Jaggayyapeta (2) Amaravathi (3) Bhattiprolu (4) Nagarjunakonda *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(2) Amaravathi**	The Amaravati Mahastupa, built along the banks of the Krishna river, is the largest and most elaborately decorated stupa in Andhra Pradesh, renowned for its exquisite limestone sculptural panels depicting scenes from the life of the Buddha.
41	Consider the following statements: 1. Satvahanas and Ikshavakus dynasties donated generously to Hindu Temples as well as Buddhist Monks. 2. Both the kingdoms also claim the performance of Shrauta sacrifice. 3. Satvahanas only donated to Hindu Temples. Which of the above statements is/are correct? (1) 1 only (2) 2 only (3) 1 and 2 (4) 2 and 3 *APPSC Assistant Tribal Welfare Officer in A.P. Tribal Welfar*	**(3) 1 and 2**	

Old PYQs and keys — row 49 (18)

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
1	Ikshvaku rulers of Andhra country practiced Vedic religion themselves but were great supporters of which religion? (1) Hinduism (2) Islam (3) Jainism (4) Buddhism *Social and Cultural History of A.P and Welfare Programmes 20*	**— no key**	
2	What was the royal religion of the Satavahanas? (1) Buddhism (2) Jainism (3) Vedic religion (4) Vaishnavism *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(3) Vedic religion**	The Satavahana kings followed the Vedic religion while patronising Buddhism.
3	Which of the following is false with regards to socio-religious and economic conditions during the Satavahana rule? (1) The Satavahana rulers followed Hinduism but some of their queens patronised Buddhism (2) The fourfold caste system existed (3) The women were looked down upon (4) There was a flourishing maritime trade *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(3) The women were looked down upon**	The statement that women were looked down upon is false, because Satavahana women enjoyed a respected status (kings used metronymics and queens made donations), while the four-fold caste system, Buddhist patronage by queens and flourishing maritime trade are accurate.
4	Gatha Saptasati is a prakrit work compiled by (1) Hala (2) Gunadya (3) Kuntala Satakarni (4) Pulomavi *APPSC Asst. BC & Tribal Welfare Officers Mains Paper-II 2017*	**— no key**	
5	Where is the Parasurameswara temple, considered to be the oldest Shiva temple? (1) Thondawada (2) Gudimallam (3) Renigunta (4) Jogula Mallavaram *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) Gudimallam**	The Parasurameswara temple at Gudimallam (Yerpedu mandal, Chittoor) houses the world’s oldest known Shiva linga.
6	The oldest Shiva Lingam of Andhra Pradesh is in which temple? (1) Nagarjunakonda (2) Srisailam (3) Hanumakonda (4) Gudimallam *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(4) Gudimallam**	The oldest Shiva Lingam in Andhra is at Gudimallam in Chittoor district, dating to the Satavahana period.

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
7	Where is the famous Shivalinga where Lord Shiva appears in Linga form? (1) Amaravati (2) Draksharama (3) Gudimallam (4) Srisailam *APPSC Group-I 1991*	**(3) Gudimallam**	The oldest Shiva Lingam in Andhra is at Gudimallam in Chittoor district, dating to the Satavahana period.
8	Where is the Parasurameswara Temple, considered to be the oldest Shiva temple, located? (1) Thondawada (2) Gudimallam (3) Renigunta (4) Jogulamba Mallavaram *APPSC Group-II 2008*	**(2) Gudimallam**	The Parasurameswara Temple at Gudimallam (Tirupati district) is regarded as one of the oldest surviving Shiva temples in India. It is famous for its unique Shiva Linga with an anthropomorphic image of Lord Shiva, dating to around the 2nd century BCE. Hence, the correct answer is Option (2). Exam Note: • Oldest Shiva Temple – Gudimallam • Deity – Pa
9	Acharya Nagarjuna propounded the 'doctrine of welfare state' in his work (1) Knew it (2) Did not know *Asst. B.C. Welfare Officer, Asst. Social Welfare Officer & A*	**Ratnavali-Rajaparikatha**	
10	Who described Sri Parvataswamy as Buddha? (1) Sankara Narayanan (2) N. Venkataramanayya (3) Karthikeya Sharma (4) Kielhorn *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(2) N. Venkataramanayya**	Nelaturi Venkataramanayya identified Sri Parvataswamy with the Buddha.
11	Center of Rajagirika Buddhist doctrine? (1) Guntupalli (2) Gudivada (3) Sriparvatam (4) Jaggayyapet *APPSC Group-II 2012*	**(1) Guntupalli**	Guntupalli was the centre of the Rajagirika school of Buddhists.
12	Who was called as 'Second Buddha' during Satavahana's rule? (1) Acharya Nagarjuna (2) Varaha (3) Bhadrabahu (4) None of the above *Junior Analyst 2011*	**(1) Acharya Nagarjuna**	
13	Who wrote the books "Suhrilekha" and "Pragnaparamitha Sastram"? (1) Acharya Nagarjuna (2) Acharya Aryadeva (3) Acharya Dharmanandi (4) Acharya Chandramukha *Grama/Ward Sachivalayam 2019 Ward Planning Secretary*	**(1) Acharya Nagarjuna**	

#	Question	Old key	Old explanation
14	What was Nagarjuna’s philosophy? (1) Madhyamika, Sunyavada (2) Advaita (3) Mahadvaita (4) Visishtadvaita *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Madhyamika, Sunyavada**	Acharya Nagarjuna propounded the Madhyamika (Sunyavada) school of Mahayana Buddhism.
15	Who propounded Sunyavada? (1) Asvaghosha (2) Nagarjuna (3) Somadeva Suri (4) Kunda Kunda Acharya *APPSC Group-I Prelims 2012 (27-05-2012)*	**(2) Nagarjuna**	Nagarjuna, a 2nd-century Buddhist philosopher, propounded Sunyavada or ‘emptiness’ and founded the Madhyamika school of Mahayana Buddhism.
16	Who wrote the book ‘Yogasara’? (1) Nagarjuna (2) Dhanapala (3) Kondakundacharya (4) Vastupala *APPSC AP History PYQ*	**(1) Nagarjuna**	Acharya Nagarjuna authored Yogasara, Rasaratnakaram, Ratnavali and Madhyamika Karika.
17	The text ’ Yogasara ’ was written by (1) Nagarjuna (2) Dhanapala (3) Konda Kundacharya (4) Vastupala *APPSC Group-2 PYQ*	**(1) Nagarjuna**	
18	Who was Nagarjuna? (1) A Greek king (2) Rushi of Vedas (3) Jain monk (4) Buddhist philosopher *APPSC Assistant Executive Engineer 2008 (02-03-2008)*	**(4) Buddhist philosopher**	Acharya Nagarjuna was a Buddhist philosopher, founder of Mahayana Buddhism and contemporary of Yajna Satakarni.